

360 Perspective

Private Infrastructure

April 2026

Important disclosures can be found in the Disclosures Appendix.



WS Global CIO Office

Contents

Portfolio Benefits of Private Infrastructure	9
Key Drivers of Infrastructure spending	14
Key Risks	26
Disclosures	28

Steve Brice
Global Chief Investment Officer

Hannah Chew
Portfolio Strategist



What are Infrastructure Assets?

Infrastructure assets are the networks and systems that provide essential services, facilitate economic activity and enable the movement or storage of goods, water, energy, data and people



Traditional Infrastructure

Upgrades on roads, rails, transport network (e.g., ports, waterways and airports); modernizing public transit; build, preserve and retrofit civic and commercial real estate; upgrading aging water infrastructure including water treatment plants, pipes, sewers, water sanitation, improving access to clean water.



Renewable Infrastructure

Investments to accelerate the adoption of renewables in primary energy supply to meet Paris agreement commitments: Upgrading the electric grid, building electric vehicle charging stations, supporting sustainable farming and circular economy initiatives, decarbonizing the energy sector.



Digital Infrastructure

Investments in digitalization initiatives (cloud, 5G, data centers), expansion of high-speed broadband, funding of scientific research, granting or improving digital access to underserved segments of the population.

Source: Standard Chartered



Key characteristics of infrastructure assets

Key characteristics

Summary

'Real' Asset Class

- Infrastructure represents a tangible asset – i.e., a combination of land and structures that constitutes real property. Real property is expected to almost always retain a residual value, which is particularly attractive during periods of distress

Essential Services

- Given the essential nature of Infrastructure services, user demand tends to be relatively inelastic. Therefore, they tend to exhibit a lower correlation to the economic cycle compared with other sectors

High Barriers of Entry

- Infrastructure requires a high level of initial capital investment, which acts as a significant impediment to potential competitors entering the market. Assets can enjoy monopolistic or quasi-monopolistic market positioning

High Regulation

- Infrastructure assets are usually essential services providers which are important in the function of society and economy. Therefore, governments tend to exercise strict regulation over them. While regulations can vary, they usually make cash flows more stable

Diversified end-user base

- The counterparties to infrastructure assets are generally a widely diversified group of end users, which helps stabilize cash flows

Cash flow predictability

- Regulation provides long-term revenue visibility to infrastructure investments

Inflation hedge

- Depending on the type of infrastructure asset, price inflation can sometimes be passed on to the end consumer. Most regulatory frameworks allow regulated assets to use inflation-indexed user tariffs

Key
characteristics
of infrastructure
assets

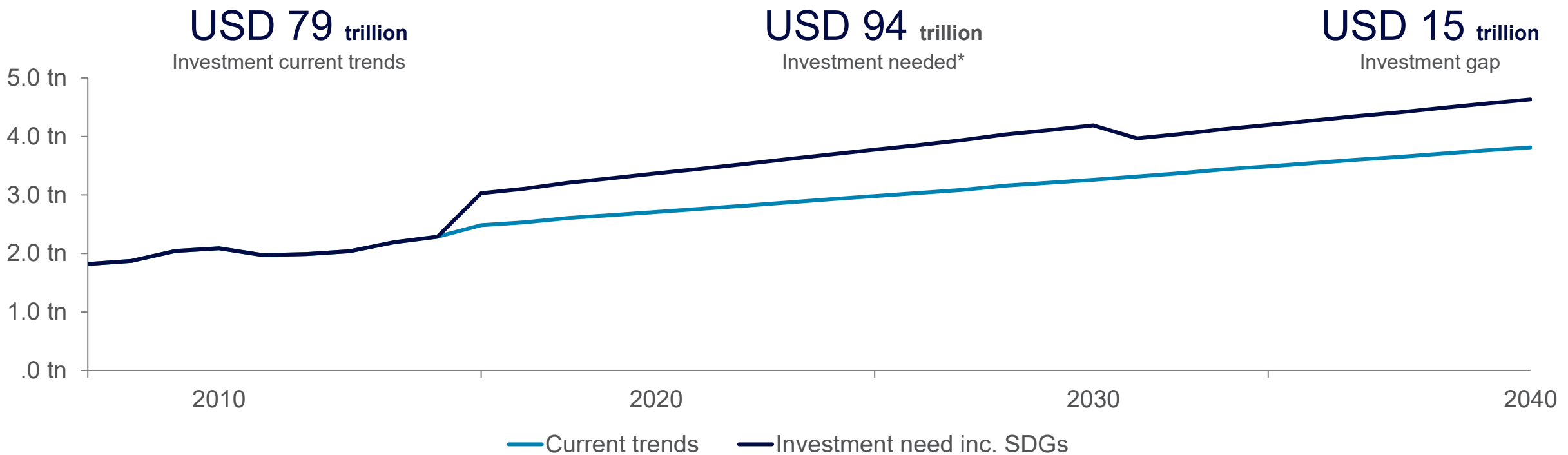
Source: Deutsche Asset Management, Standard Chartered



The Infrastructure “super-cycle”

Post-COVID, major governments are investing heavily in infrastructure assets to achieve supply chain resilience, digital independence and environmental targets

Global infrastructure investment spend has trailed behind actual needs



Source: Global Infrastructure Outlook, Standard Chartered
*Includes the additional investment needed for countries that have not yet met the SDGs
Note: values refer to estimated investment spending and needs until 2040
SDG refer to United Nations Sustainable Development Goals



The definition of infrastructure is evolving to meet future needs

From traditional, asset-heavy sectors...

Asset-heavy

Large; physical, high-capex-assets

Highly regulated

Government-owned and monopoly models

Linear and centralized

Centralized grids, fixed networks

Capex-intensive

Heavy investments upfront

Built on long-established technologies

Fossil fuels, resource-heavy

... to inclusion of services, technology, and distributed systems



Tech-enabled

Digital, software-driven infrastructure as a service



Market-driven

Private-sector competition and digital platforms



Decentralized and modular

Distributed, flexible, and demand driven



Opex and services

Pay-as-you-go, cloud-based subscription models

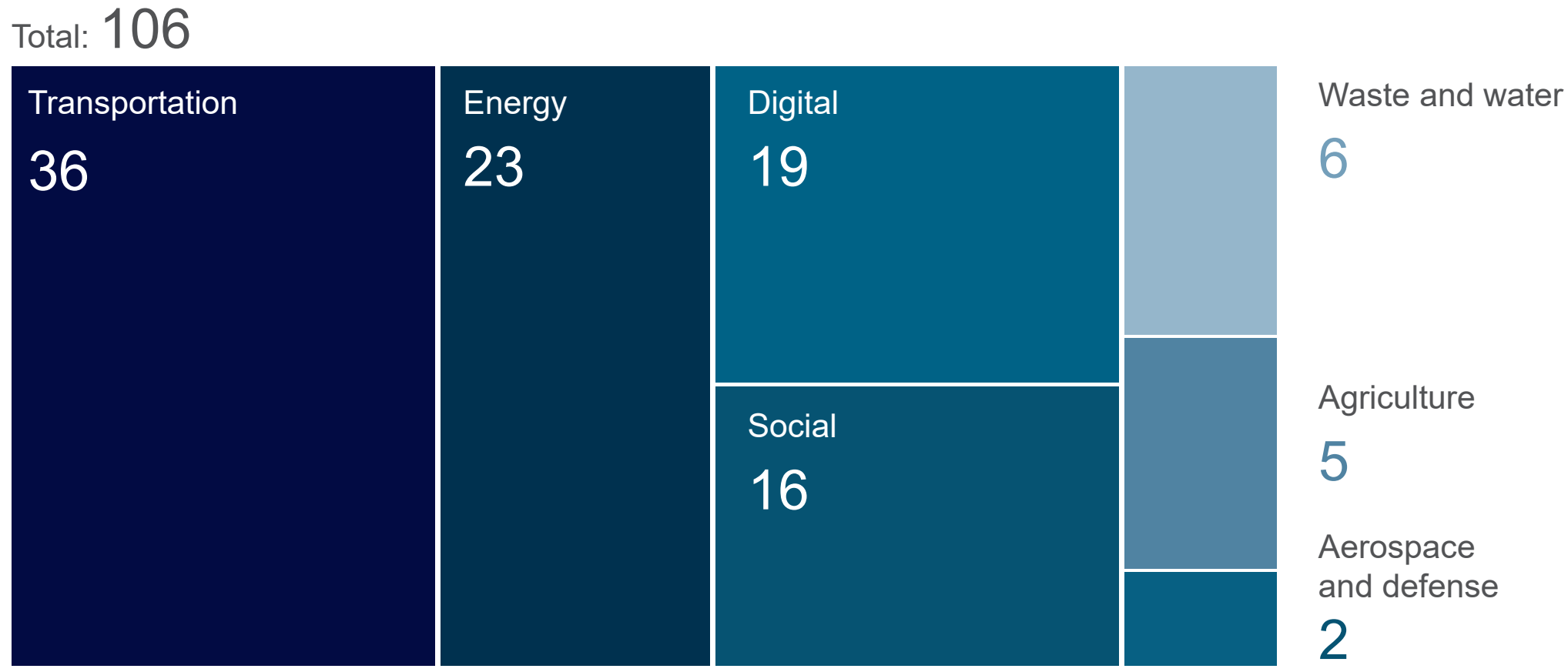


Built on scaling and disruptive technologies

Low-carbon, circular economy, sustainability driven

Cumulative infrastructure investment is expected to reach as high as \$106 trillion by 2040

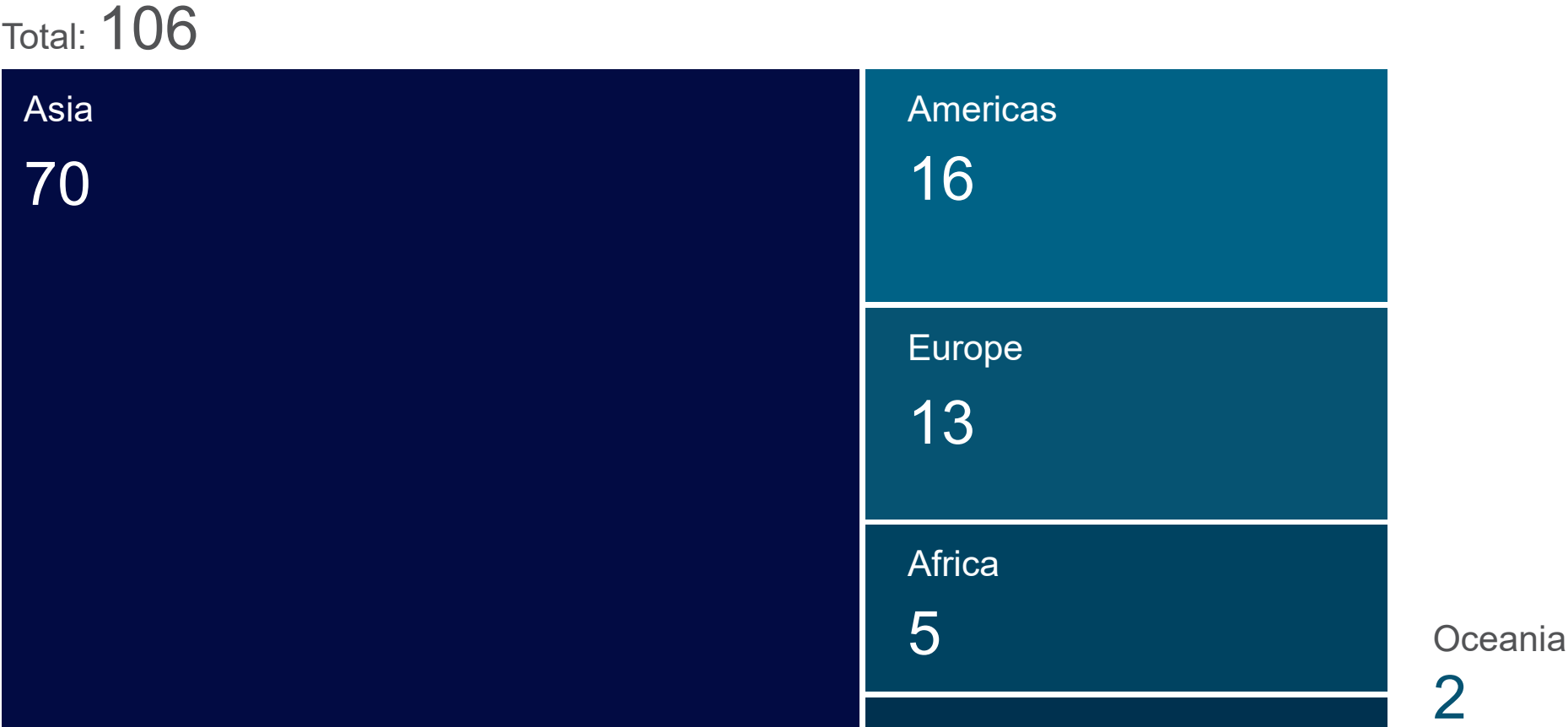
Total infrastructure investment projected through 2040, by sector, \$ trillion



Source: Food and Agriculture Organization; Global Infrastructure Hub; International Energy Agency; International Monetary Fund; Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development; Preqin; United Nations; World Bank; World Economic Forum; McKinsey
Note: Figures do not sum, because of rounding

Asia could receive two-thirds of the total infrastructure investment through 2040

Total infrastructure investment projected through 2040, by region, \$ trillion



Source: Food and Agriculture Organization; Global Infrastructure Hub; International Energy Agency; International Monetary Fund; Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development: Preqin; United Nations; World Bank; World Economic Forum; McKinsey

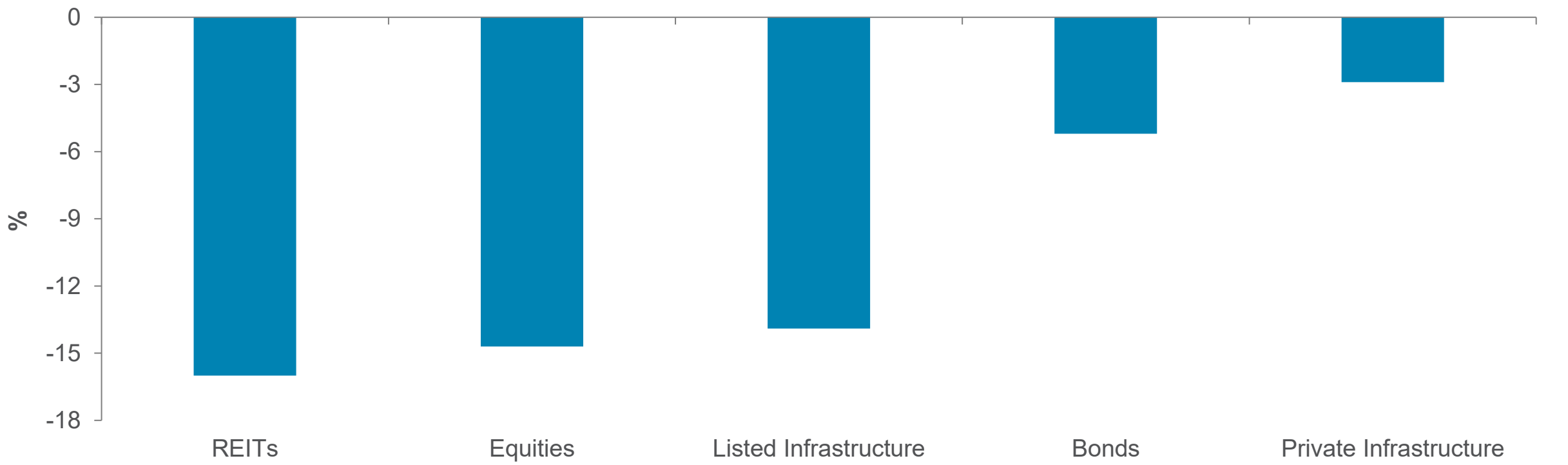


Portfolio Benefits of Private Infrastructure

Private infrastructure assets have demonstrated resilient returns during drawdowns

History suggests that infrastructure assets tend to perform relatively well compared to traditional assets during worst performing quarters for equity markets

Average return by asset class during 10 worst quarters for equity markets



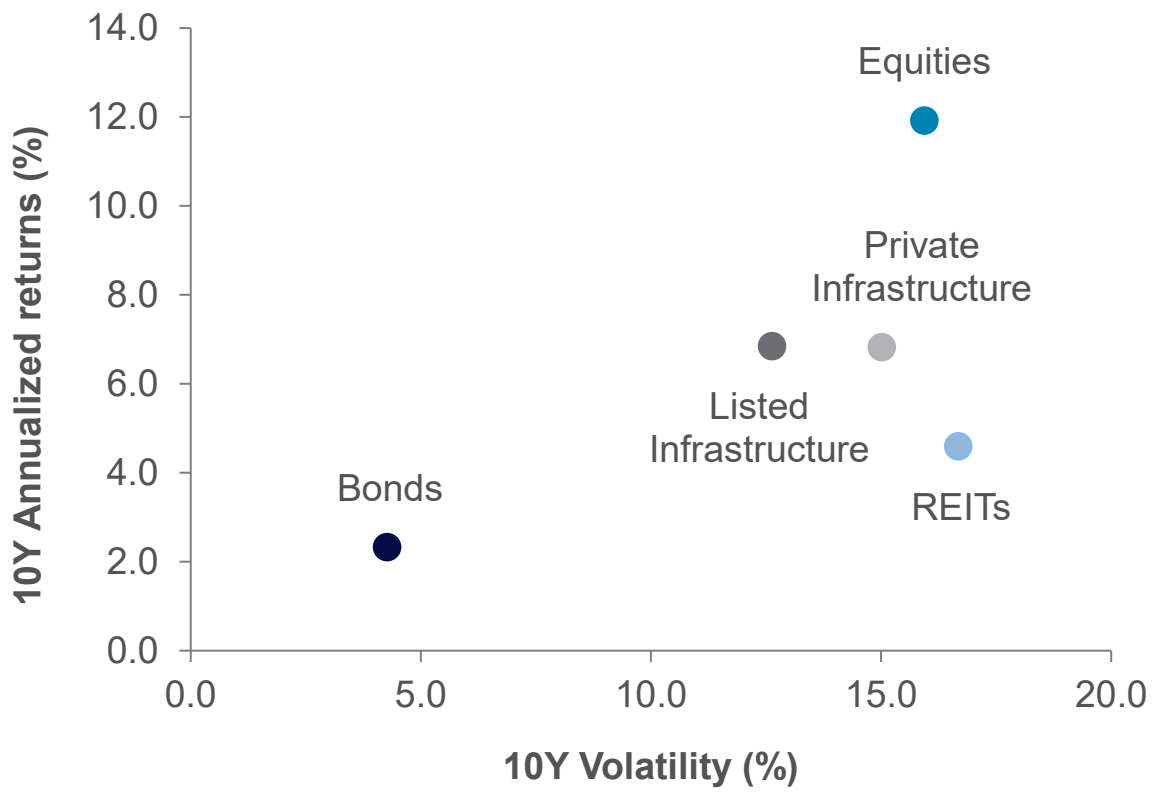
Source: Allianz Research, Standard Chartered



Private infrastructure is often less correlated to traditional asset classes

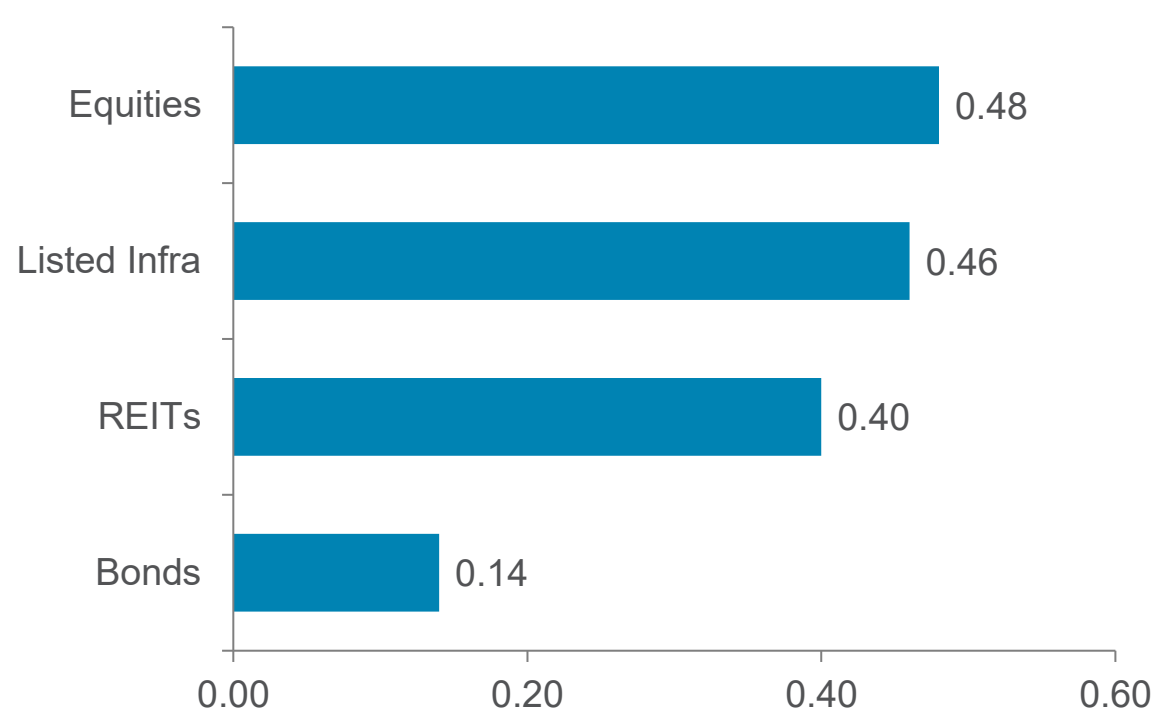
It also has relatively lower volatility compared to equities and REITs, given its regular cash flow which can mitigate downside price volatility

10Y Risk/Return matrix across Asset Class



Source: Bloomberg, The Scientific Infrastructure & Private Assets Research Institute (EIPA), Standard Chartered Bank
Data as of September 2025

10Y Correlation with Private Infrastructure



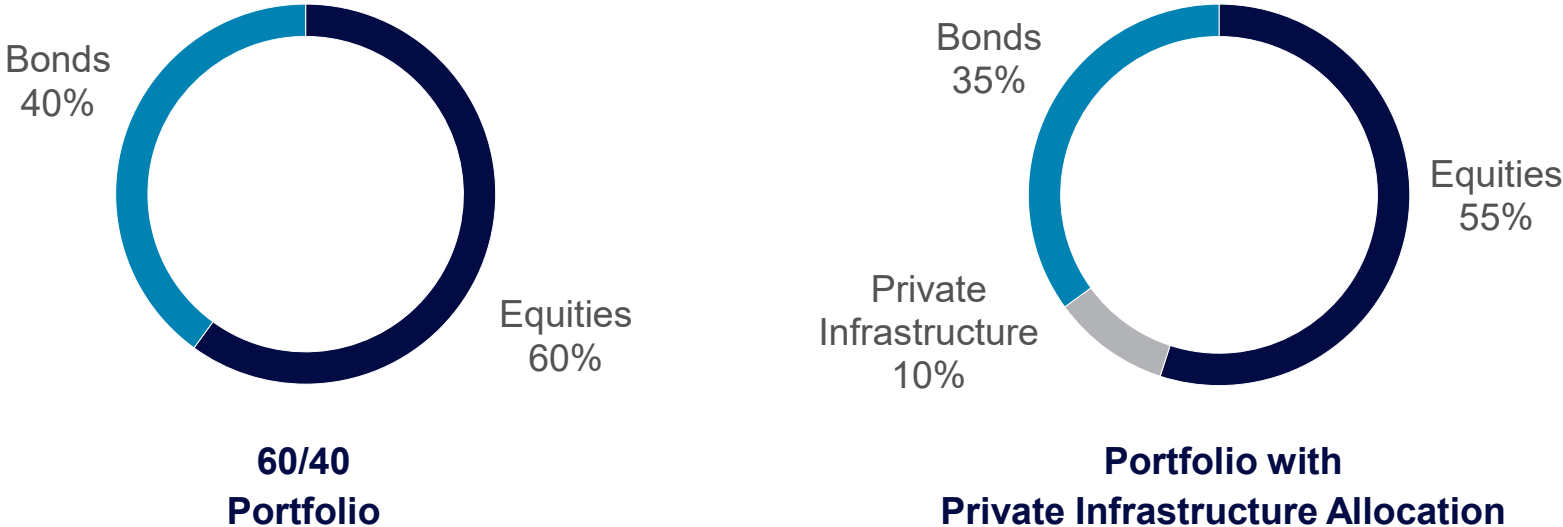
Source: Allianz Research, Standard Chartered Bank
Data as of 2024



Adding Private infrastructure could improve risk-adjusted returns in a portfolio

An allocation towards Private Infrastructure, which is a less volatile asset, can improve a portfolio's risk-adjusted returns

Performance of a portfolio with a private infrastructure allocation vs a Traditional 60/40 Portfolio



	60/40 Portfolio	Portfolio with Private Infrastructure Allocation
Historical 10Y Ann. Return	8.7%	9.0%
Historical Volatility	11.1%	10.3%
Sharpe Ratio	0.47	0.54

Source: StashAway, Standard Chartered
Data as of September 2024



Infrastructure assets are generally resilient through an economic cycle

Private Infrastructure assets can help hedge against inflation as cash flows are typically inflation-linked, which is a valuable attribute during periods of high inflation



Income

Given their essential nature, infrastructure investments can generate relatively stable and resilient cash-flows in a range of market environments



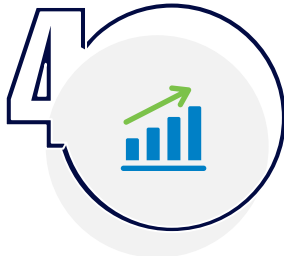
Downside Protection

The essential nature of the business allows it to remain resilient through an economic cycle, usually limiting drawdowns at least relative to public market assets



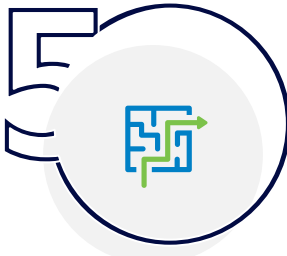
Stability of Cashflow

Infrastructure's contractual business nature helps provide investors with long-term visibility into cash flows with usually less exposure to price volatility and volume risk



Inflation Protection

Private Infrastructure cash flow are usually indexed to inflation. There are also often pass-through clauses for higher costs given the essential nature of their underlying business



Diversification

Private Infrastructure has a relatively low volatility relative to, and correlation with, traditional asset classes



Sustainability

The global shift towards net-zero suggests that investment into supporting infrastructure will increase as countries push to overhaul their existing carbon-based infrastructure

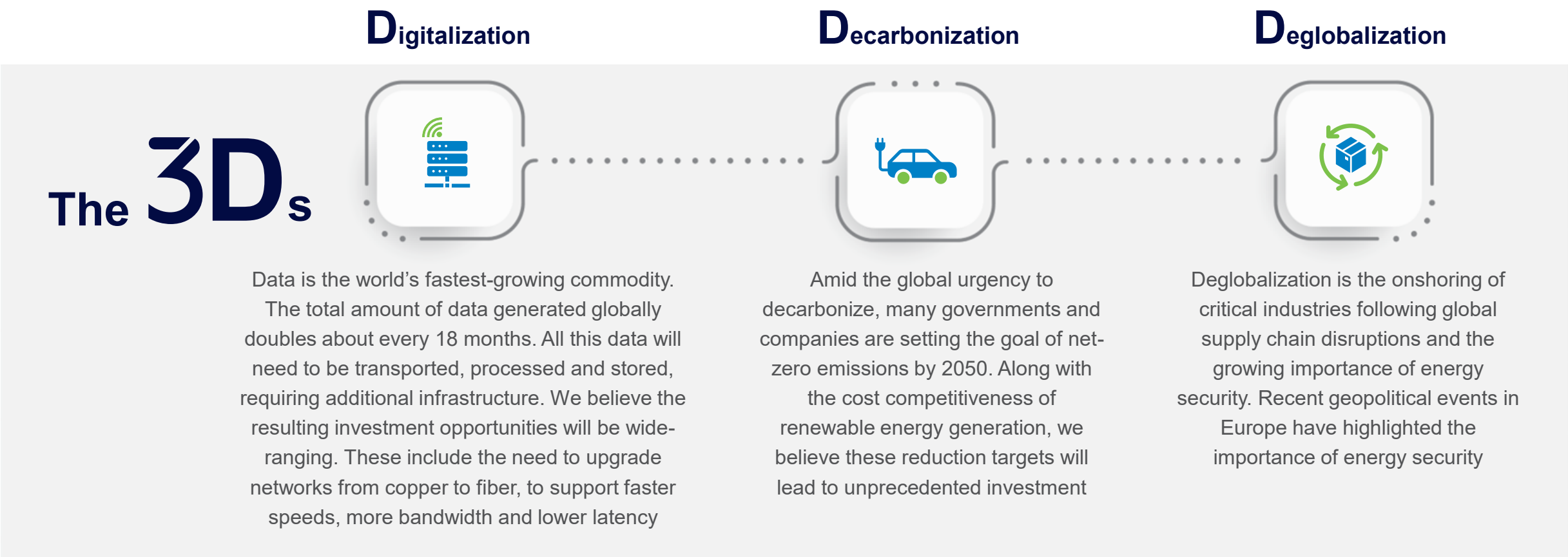
Source: Standard Chartered



Key Drivers of Infrastructure spending

The 3Ds of Infrastructure Opportunities

The infrastructure needs to enable long-term trends, including the investment to meet the staggering growth in data consumption, the shift away from traditional fossil fuels and the acceleration toward e-commerce, require a tremendous amount of capital

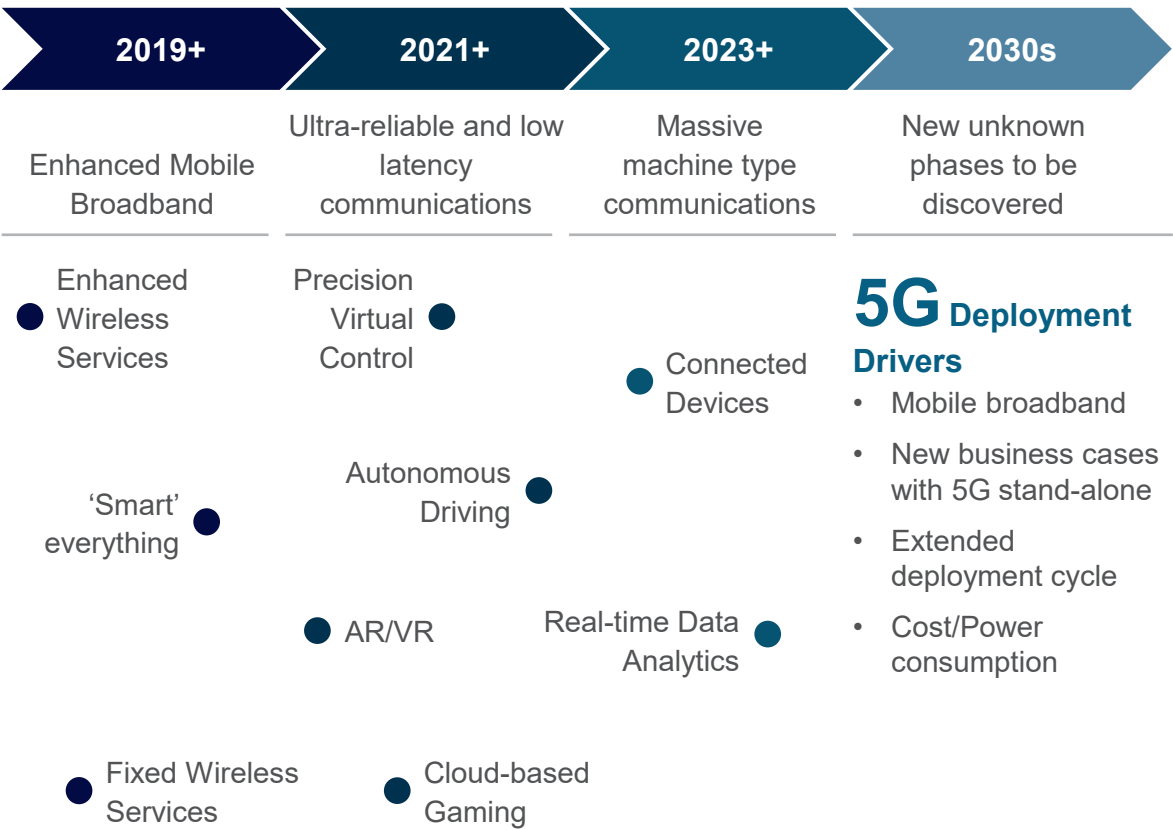


Source: Brookfield, Standard Chartered

Greater 5G adoption to drive spending on digital infrastructure

The construction of higher speed, lower latency 5G networks is expected to open a host of applications that previously were not viable. These applications are likely to drive Digital Infrastructure spending

5G Development Stages



Source: NXP Semiconductor, Standard Chartered

Infrastructure needs to support the Application of 5G

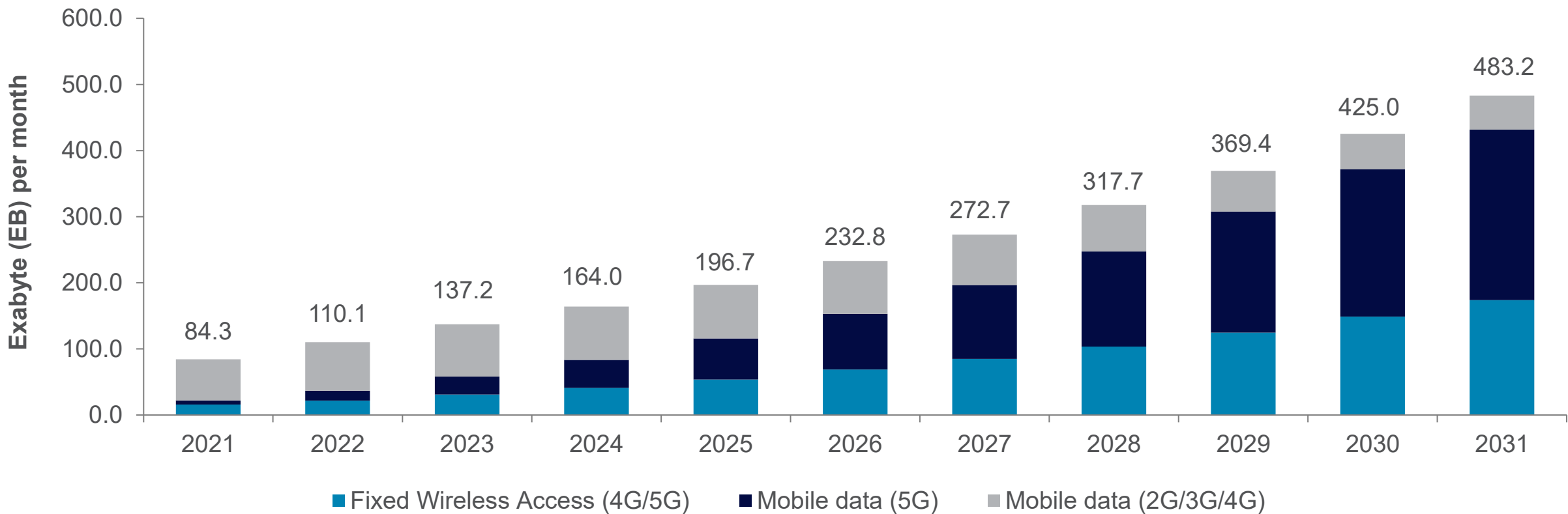


Source: Digi, Standard Chartered

The future of Data Consumption

Mobile data network consumption is expected to grow steadily and the need for more data centers and faster network infrastructure will drive investment needs

Global mobile network data traffic and forecasts



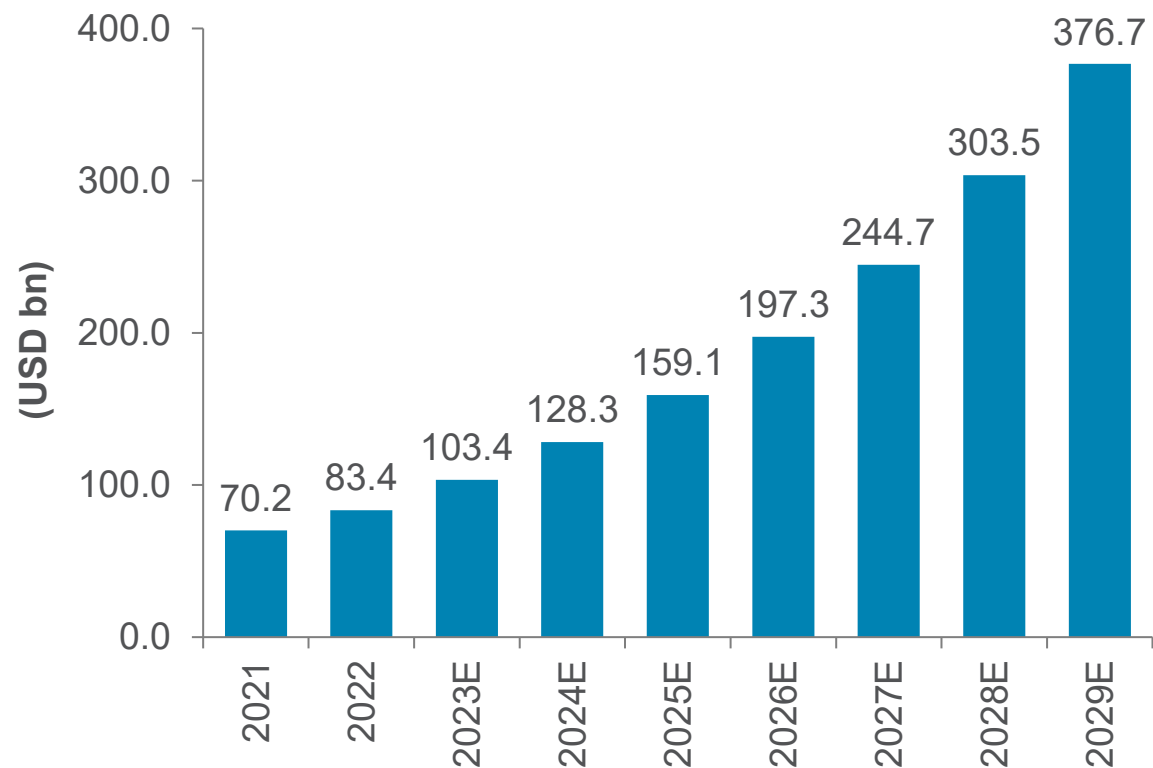
Source: Ericsson Mobility Report, Standard Chartered



The future of Digitalization

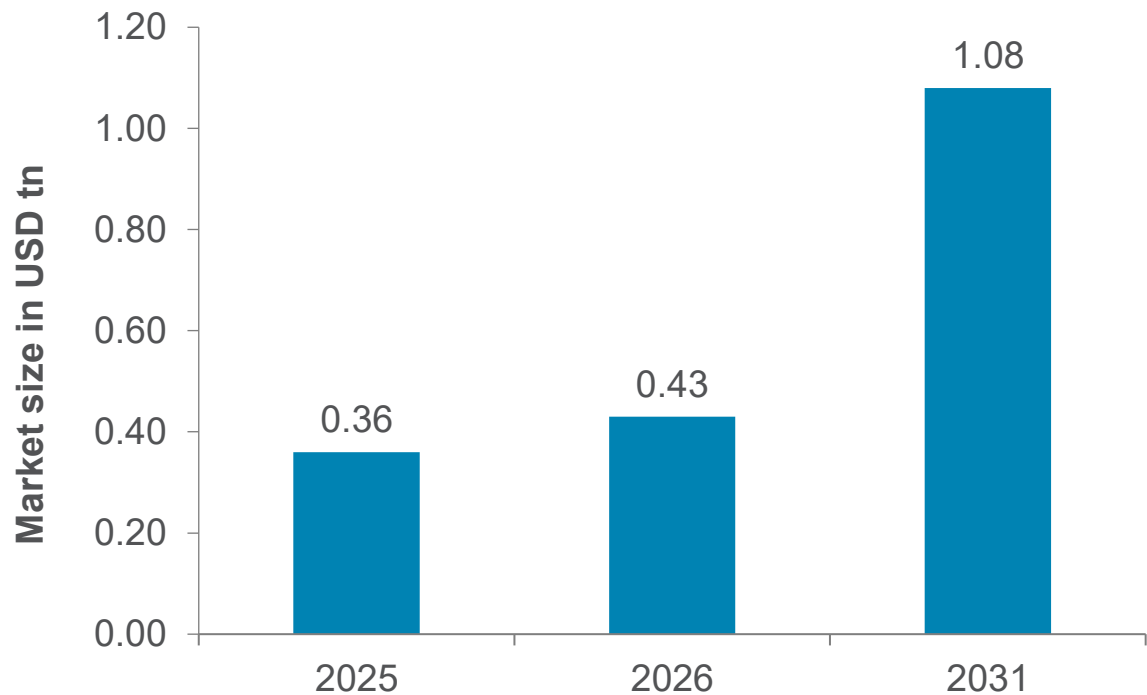
As the world marches towards digitalization, the growth in Digital Infrastructure spending is set to persist

Growth of Cloud Storage Market size



Source: Upwork, Synergy Research Group, Global X, Statista, Standard Chartered

Digital infrastructure markets are expected to grow at a CAGR of 20% from 2026 to 2031



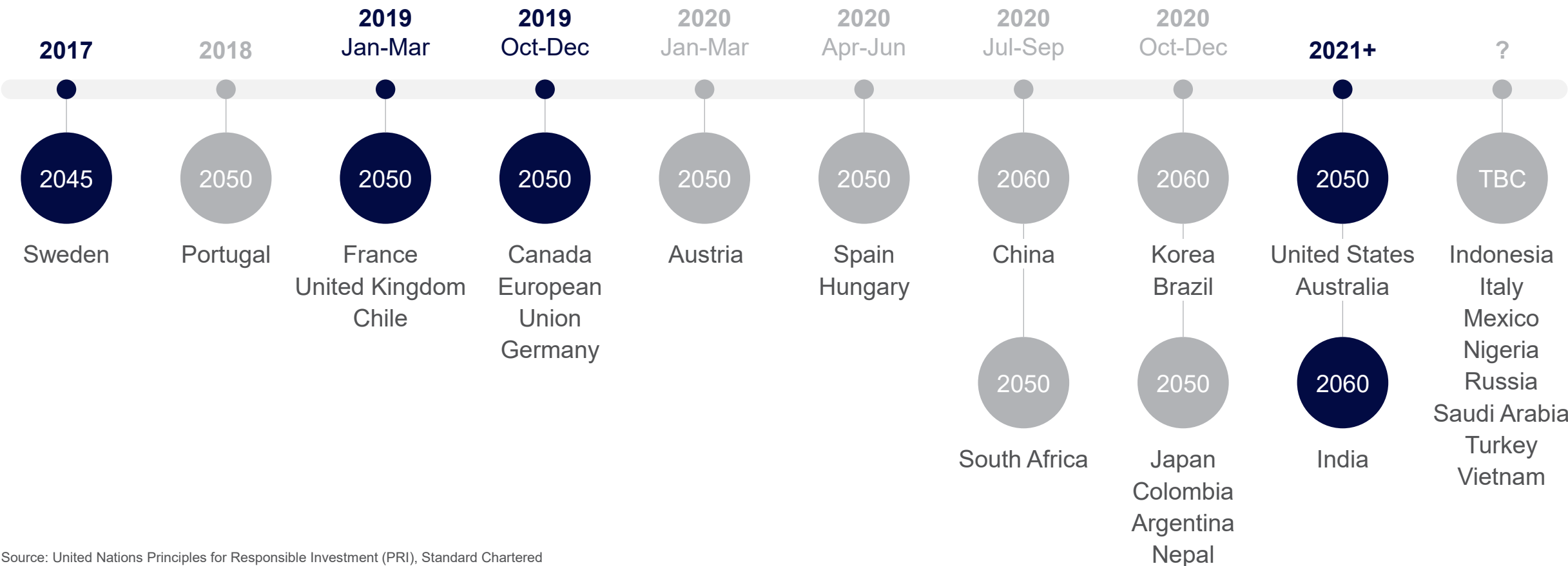
Source: Mordor Intelligence, Standard Chartered



Government pledges toward net zero carbon emissions

As the world look towards decarbonizing in the decades ahead, policies and investments are needed to overhaul existing infrastructure to achieve net-zero targets

Announcement timeline for net zero emissions targets



Source: United Nations Principles for Responsible Investment (PRI), Standard Chartered



Unprecedented investment in the build-out of renewable infrastructure

Many reduction targets will require significant capital investment to overhaul the power generation sector, the world's largest source of carbon emissions

Expected investment needed to transition energy systems by 2050

USD 150 trillion

Total investment to transition energy system by 2050



Build out renewable
power generation

Global
Electrification

Enhance electrical
infrastructure

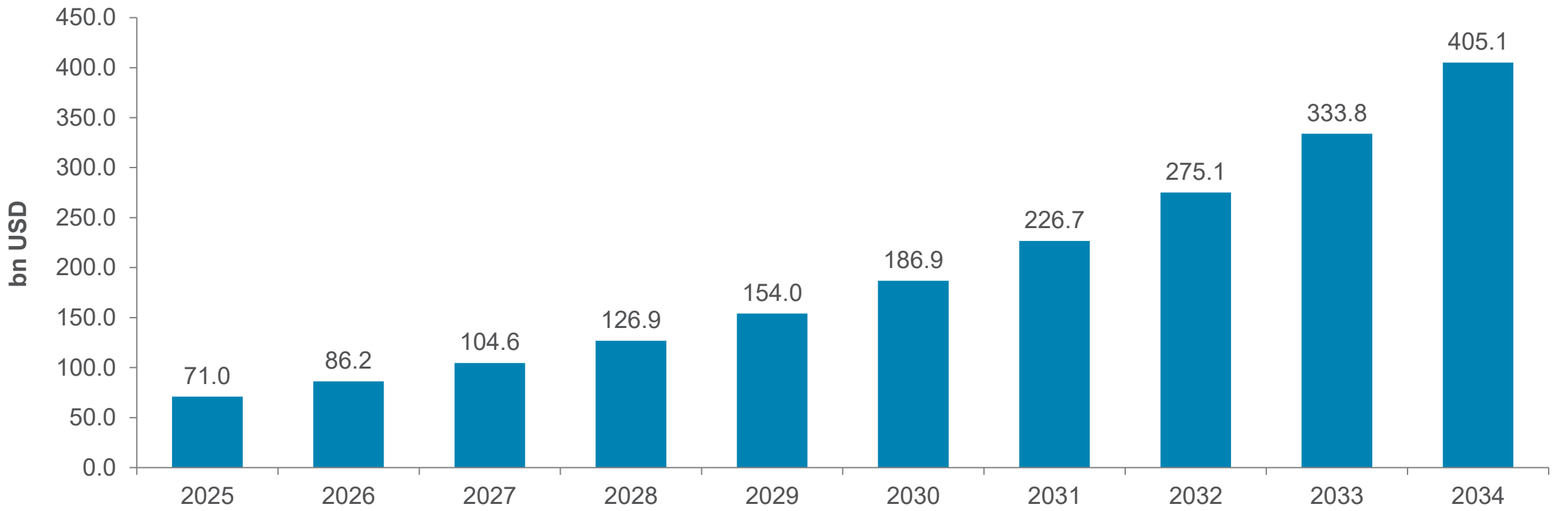
Repurpose existing
infrastructure assets

Source: Brookfield, Standard Chartered

The renewable infrastructure rush

Rising environmental awareness and government pressure for carbon-neutral construction methods are driving market growth for sustainable infrastructure

Sustainable Infrastructure Market Size



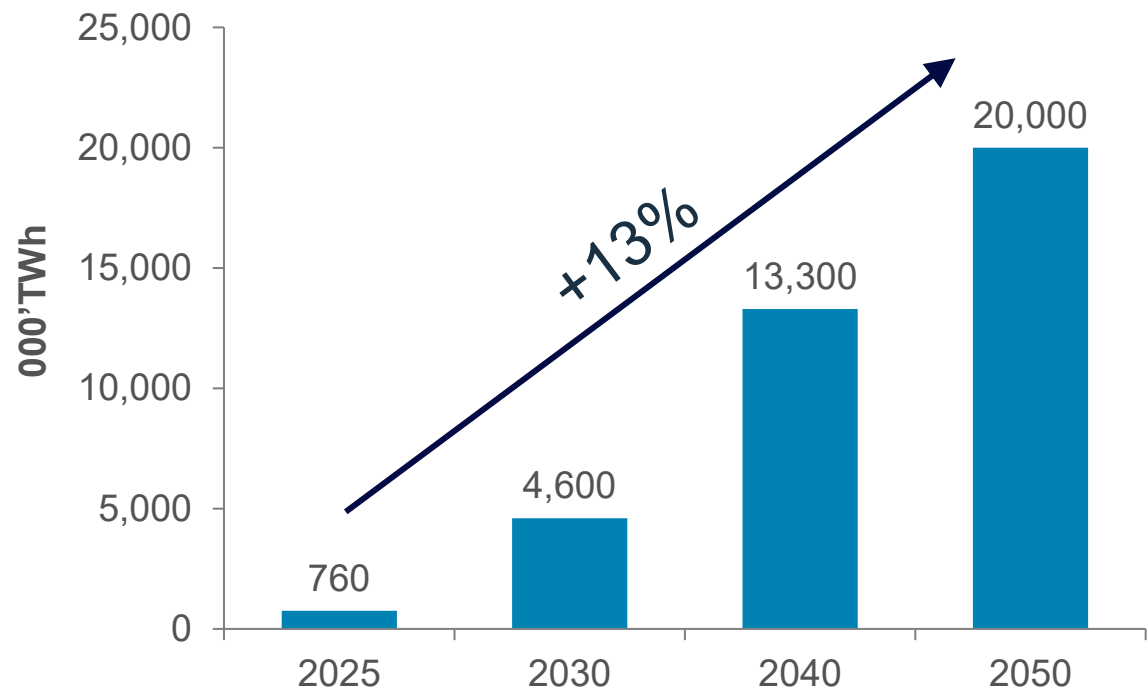
Source: Precedence Research, Standard Chartered



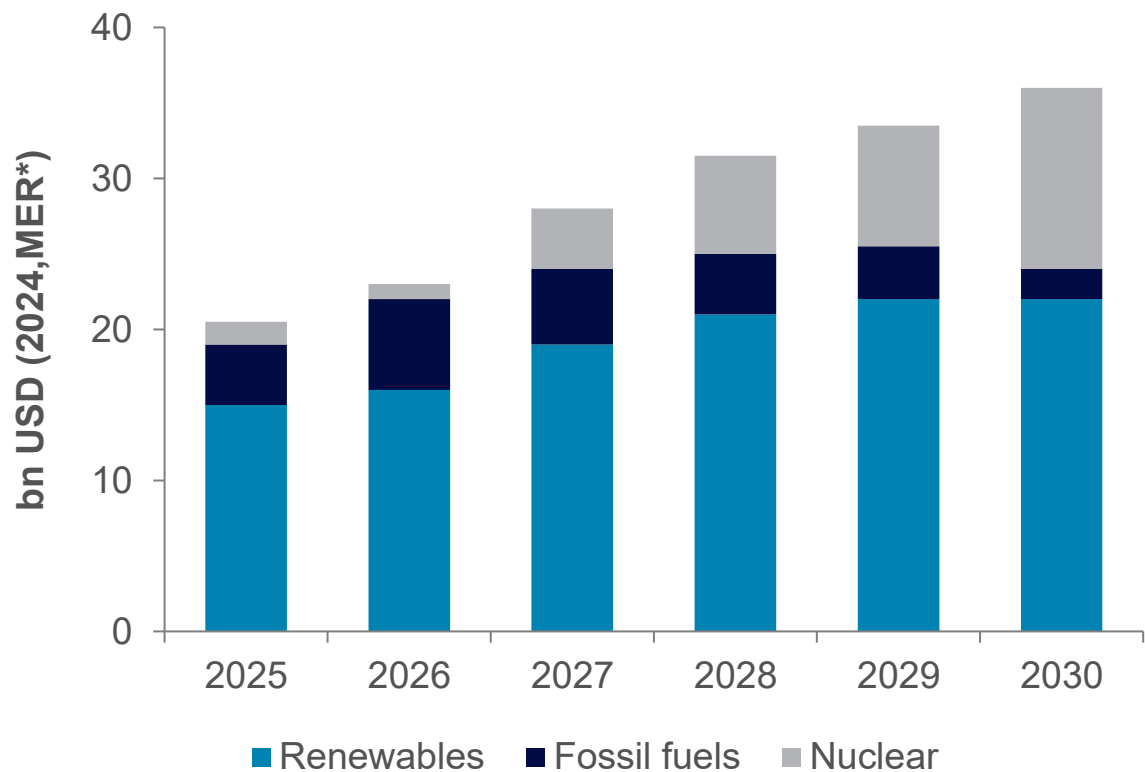
Acceleration of demand for global electricity

Data centres are driving demand for energy, and renewable energy infrastructure is meeting it

Global Electricity Demand Growth, with data centers projected 17% annual growth between 2025 to 2050



New power generation investment for data centers



Source: Brookfield, Standard Chartered

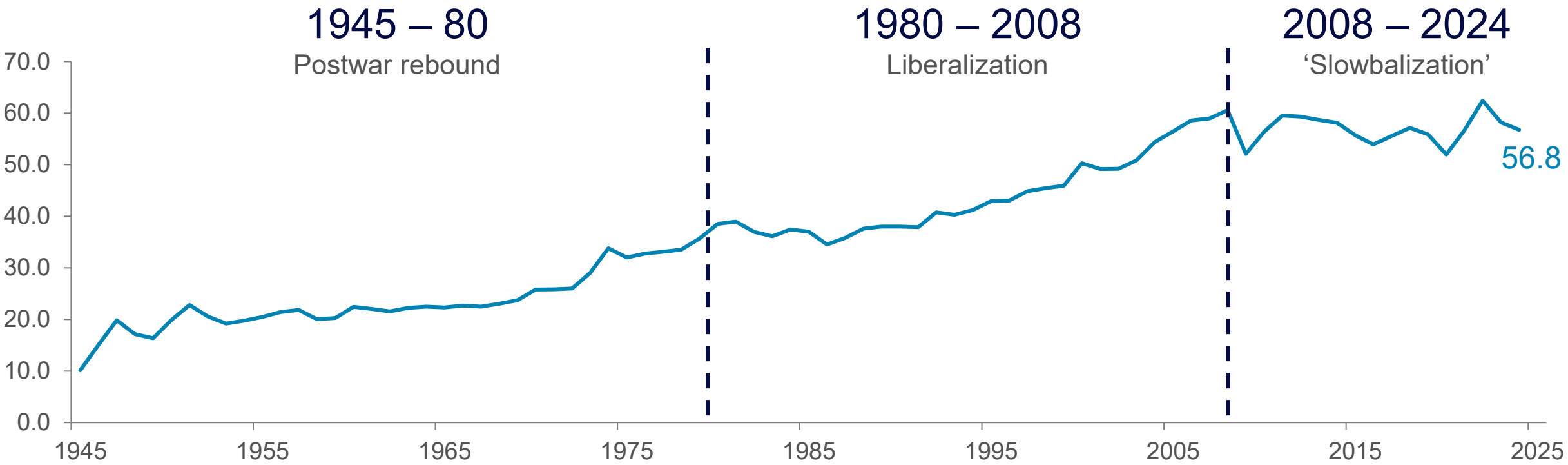
Source: International Energy Agency (IEA) World Investment Energy 2025 Report, Standard Chartered
* Market Exchange Rate



Globalization is in retreat for the first time since World War II

The pandemic has exposed the need for countries to onshore critical industries like energy security, supply chains and technology infrastructure

Global economy trade openness index

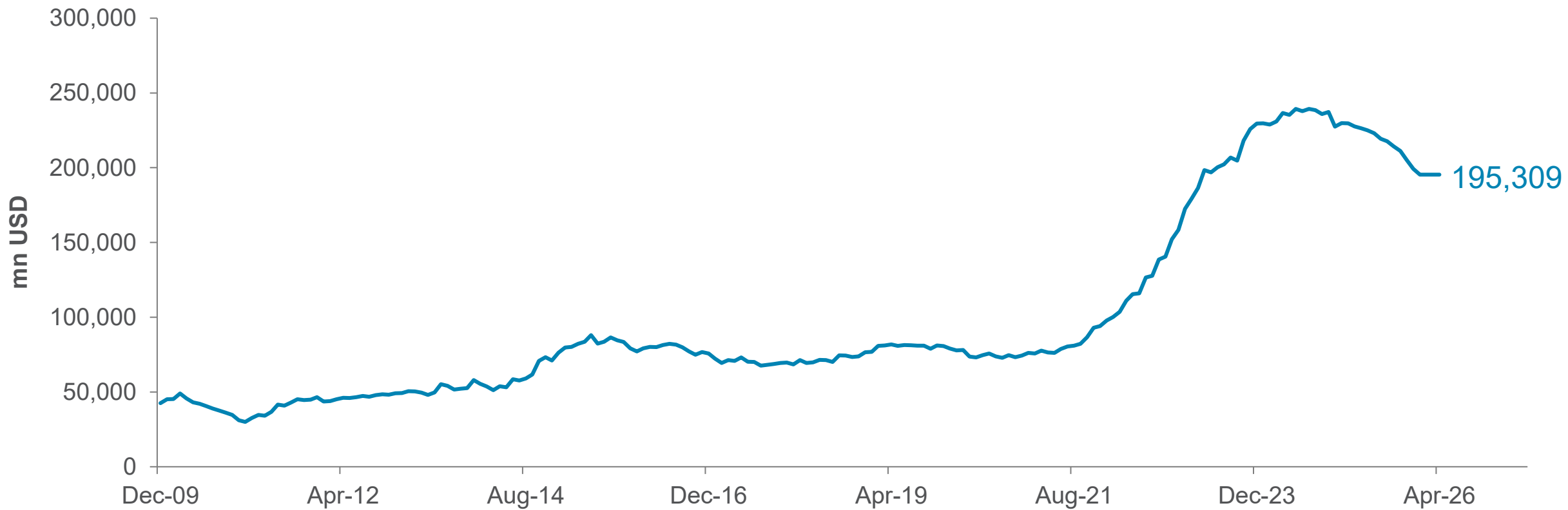


Source: Our World in Data, Peterson Institute for International Economics (PIIE), Standard Chartered
Note: National statistical organizations and central banks, OECD national accounts, and World Bank staff estimates (2026)Feenstra et al. - Penn World Table (2025)Klasing, Mariko J. and Milionis, P. (2014). "Quantifying the Evolution of World Trade, 1870-1949". Journal of International Economics 92(1), pp. 185-197Estevadeordal, A., Frantz, B., & Taylor, A. (2003). The Rise and Fall of World Trade, 1870-1939. The Quarterly Journal of Economics, 118(2), 359-407. Retrieved from <http://www.jstor.org/stable/25053910> – with major processing by Our World in Data

Rising geopolitical tension a threat to globalization

Geopolitical tensions is one of the drivers expected to drive reshoring efforts

Total US Private Construction Spending on Manufacturing



Source: Bloomberg, Standard Chartered



Takeaways: Decarbonization, Deglobalization and Digitalization to support spending on infrastructure assets

Key Drivers



Digitalization

Governments have earmarked digital infrastructure as a key focus area in their stimulus plans. Digital infrastructure is the foundation on which digital economic activities, technological applications and significant productivity gains can be built on.

Decarbonization

A convergence of interest in climate change from governments, corporates and individuals is accelerating the transition to a 'net zero' economy, of which the power and transport sector have a key role to play.

Deglobalization

Recent geopolitical events have highlighted the importance of onshoring critical industries. The pandemic has also revealed the inefficiencies and un-reliabilities in the existing supply chain infrastructure.



Key Risks

Key Risks

Risks	Summary
01 Political and Regulatory Risk	• Infrastructure assets are essential services that ensures the functioning of society and the modern economy; hence governments tend to maintain certain control or regulation over them • The level of exposure to political developments as well as the tightness of regulation differs from one country or sector to another and can have a significant impact on investment returns
02 Construction Risk	• In greenfield projects, construction risk are involved. Such risk includes project overruns and delays. These risks can be common for complex projects such as bridges or energy plants. Any project overruns or delays will usually cause delayed revenues and reduced returns
03 Operational Risk	• When an infrastructure asset is operating, operational risks will be involved, including performance or maintenance risks. Performance risk can include falling short of volume or price objectives or increased costs of doing business. Maintenance risk includes unplanned maintenance costs that can reduce operating cash flow levels. Exposure to operational risk varies by asset type • Regulated assets like electricity grids are typically more protected against certain risks through regulatory formulas or cost pass through to the customer, while unregulated assets are usually more exposed
04 Financial Risk	• Depending on the level of leverage and the debt structure, infrastructure assets can be exposed to interest rate volatility or refinancing risk. If not hedged, interest costs may increase, reducing operating cash flow levels

Source: Deutsche Asset Management, Standard Chartered



Disclosures

This document is confidential and may also be privileged. If you are not the intended recipient, please destroy all copies and notify the sender immediately. This document is being distributed for general information only and is subject to the relevant disclaimers available at our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures. It is not and does not constitute research material, independent research, an offer, recommendation or solicitation to enter into any transaction or adopt any hedging, trading or investment strategy, in relation to any securities or other financial instruments. This document is for general evaluation only. It does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs of any particular person or class of persons and it has not been prepared for any particular person or class of persons. You should not rely on any contents of this document in making any investment decisions. Before making any investment, you should carefully read the relevant offering documents and seek independent legal, tax and regulatory advice. In particular, we recommend you to seek advice regarding the suitability of the investment product, taking into account your specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs, before you make a commitment to purchase the investment product. Opinions, projections and estimates are solely those of SC at the date of this document and subject to change without notice. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. The value of investments, and the income from them, can go down as well as up, and you may not recover the amount of your original investment. You are not certain to make a profit and may lose money. Any forecast contained herein as to likely future movements in rates or prices or likely future events or occurrences constitutes an opinion only and is not indicative of actual future movements in rates or prices or actual future events or occurrences (as the case may be). This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of the Standard Chartered Group (as defined below). Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered PLC, the ultimate parent company of Standard Chartered Bank, together with its subsidiaries and affiliates (including each branch or representative office), form the Standard Chartered Group. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of Standard Chartered. Private banking activities may be carried out internationally by different legal entities and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group (each an “SC Group Entity”) according to local regulatory requirements. Not all products and services are provided by all branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group. Some of the SC Group Entities only act as representatives of Standard Chartered Private Bank and may not be able to offer products and services or offer advice to clients.

Copyright © 2026, Accounting Research & Analytics, LLC d/b/a CFRA (and its affiliates, as applicable). Reproduction of content provided by CFRA in any form is prohibited except with the prior written permission of CFRA. CFRA content is not investment advice and a reference to or observation concerning a security or investment provided in the CFRA SERVICES is not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold such investment or security or make any other investment decisions. The CFRA content contains opinions of CFRA based upon publicly-available information that CFRA believes to be reliable and the opinions are subject to change without notice. This analysis has not been submitted to, nor received approval from, the United States Securities and Exchange Commission or any other regulatory body. While CFRA exercised due care in compiling this analysis, CFRA, ITS THIRD-PARTY SUPPLIERS, AND ALL RELATED ENTITIES SPECIFICALLY DISCLAIM ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, ANY WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE OR USE, to the full extent permitted by law, regarding the accuracy, completeness, or usefulness of this information and assumes no liability with respect to the consequences of relying on this information for investment or other purposes. No content provided by CFRA (including ratings, credit-related analyses and data, valuations, model, software or other application or output therefrom) or any part thereof may be modified, reverse engineered, reproduced or distributed in any form by any means, or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of CFRA, and such content shall not be used for any unlawful or unauthorized purposes. CFRA and any third-party providers, as well as their directors, officers, shareholders, employees or agents do not guarantee the accuracy, completeness, timeliness or availability of such content. In no event shall CFRA, its affiliates, or their third-party suppliers be liable for any direct, indirect, special, or consequential damages, costs, expenses, legal fees, or losses (including lost income or lost profit and opportunity costs) in connection with a subscriber's, subscriber's customer's, or other's use of CFRA's content.

Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) Disclaimer

Banking activities may be carried out internationally by different branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group according to local regulatory requirements. Opinions may contain outright “buy”, “sell”, “hold” or other opinions. The time horizon of this opinion is dependent on prevailing market conditions and there is no planned frequency for updates to the opinion. This opinion is not independent of Standard Chartered Group's trading strategies or positions. Standard Chartered Group and/or its affiliates or its respective officers, directors, employee benefit programmes or employees, including persons involved in the preparation or issuance of this document may at any time, to the extent permitted by applicable law and/or regulation, be long or short any securities or financial instruments referred to in this document or have material interest in any such securities or related



Disclosures

investments. Therefore, it is possible, and you should assume, that Standard Chartered Group has a material interest in one or more of the financial instruments mentioned herein. Please refer to our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures for more detailed disclosures, including past opinions/ recommendations in the last 12 months and conflict of interests, as well as disclaimers. A covering strategist may have a financial interest in the debt or equity securities of this company/issuer. All covering strategist are licensed to provide investment recommendations under Monetary Authority of Singapore or Hong Kong Monetary Authority. This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of Standard Chartered Group.

Sustainable Investments

Any ESG data used or referred to has been provided by Morningstar, Sustainalytics, MSCI or Bloomberg. Refer to 1) Morningstar website under Sustainable Investing, 2) Sustainalytics website under ESG Risk Ratings, 3) MSCI website under ESG Business Involvement Screening Research and 4) Bloomberg green, social & sustainability bonds guide for more information. The ESG data is as at the date of publication based on data provided, is for informational purpose only and is not warranted to be complete, timely, accurate or suitable for a particular purpose, and it may be subject to change. Sustainable Investments (SI): This refers to funds that have been classified as 'ESG Intentional Investments - Overall' by Morningstar. SI funds have explicitly stated in their prospectus and regulatory filings that they either incorporate ESG factors into the investment process or have a thematic focus on the environment, gender diversity, low carbon, renewable energy, water or community development. For equity, it refers to shares/stocks issued by companies with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible. For bonds, it refers to debt instruments issued by issuers with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible, and/or those being certified green, social, sustainable bonds by Bloomberg. For structured products, it refers to products that are issued by any issuer who has a Sustainable Finance framework that aligns with Standard Chartered's Green and Sustainable Product Framework, with underlying assets that are part of the Sustainable Investment universe or separately approved by Standard Chartered's Sustainable Finance Governance Committee. Sustainalytics ESG risk ratings shown are factual and are not an indicator that the product is classified or marketed as "green", "sustainable" or similar under any particular classification system or framework.

Country/Market Specific Disclosures

Bahrain: This document is being distributed in Bahrain by Standard Chartered Bank, Bahrain Branch, having its address at P.O. 29, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain, is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed by the Central Bank of Bahrain as a conventional retail bank. **Botswana:** This document is being distributed in Botswana by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank Botswana Limited which is a financial institution licensed under the Section 6 of the Banking Act CAP 46:04 and is listed in the Botswana Stock Exchange. **Brunei Darussalam:** This document is being distributed in Brunei Darussalam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Brunei Branch) | Registration Number RFC/61 and Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd | Registration Number RC20001003. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd is a limited liability company registered with the Registry of Companies with Registration Number RC20001003 and licensed by Brunei Darussalam Central Bank as a Capital Markets Service License Holder with License Number BDCB/R/CMU/S3-CL and it is authorised to conduct Islamic investment business through an Islamic window. **China Mainland:** This document is being distributed in China by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (China) Limited which is mainly regulated by National Financial Regulatory Administration (NFRA), State Administration of Foreign Exchange (SAFE), and People's Bank of China (PBOC). **Hong Kong:** In Hong Kong, this document, except for any portion advising on or facilitating any decision on futures contracts trading, is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("SCBHK"), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. SCBHK has its registered address at 32/F, Standard Chartered Bank Building, 4-4A Des Voeux Road Central, Hong Kong and is regulated by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority and registered with the Securities and Futures Commission ("SFC") to carry on Type 1 (dealing in securities), Type 4 (advising on securities), Type 6 (advising on corporate finance) and Type 9 (asset management) regulated activity under the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571) ("SFO") (CE No. AJ1614). The contents of this document have not been reviewed by any regulatory authority in Hong Kong and you are advised to exercise caution in relation to any offer set out herein. If you are in doubt about any of the contents of this document, you should obtain independent professional advice. Any product named herein may not be offered or sold in Hong Kong by means of any document at any time other than to "professional investors" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance. In addition, this document may not be issued or possessed for the purposes of issue, whether in Hong Kong or elsewhere, and any interests may not be disposed of, to any person unless such person is outside Hong Kong or is a "professional investor" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance, or as otherwise may be permitted by that ordinance. In Hong Kong, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBHK, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. **Ghana:** Standard Chartered Bank Ghana Limited accepts no liability and will not be liable for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. Past performance



Disclosures

is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to feedback.ghana@sc.com. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 0302610750 for any questions or service queries. You are advised not to send any confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail, as Standard Chartered makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. Standard Chartered shall not be responsible for any loss or damage suffered by you arising from your decision to use e-mail to communicate with the Bank.

India: This document is being distributed in India by Standard Chartered in its capacity as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of any other third party financial products. Standard Chartered does not offer any 'Investment Advice' as defined in the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013 or otherwise. Services/products related securities business offered by Standard Chartered are not intended for any person, who is a resident of any jurisdiction, the laws of which imposes prohibition on soliciting the securities business in that jurisdiction without going through the registration requirements and/or prohibit the use of any information contained in this document. **Indonesia:** This document is being distributed in Indonesia by Standard Chartered Bank, Indonesia branch, which is a financial institution licensed and supervised by Otoritas Jasa Keuangan (Financial Service Authority) and Bank Indonesia. **Jersey:** In Jersey, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the Registered Business Name of the Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is regulated by the Jersey Financial Services Commission. Copies of the latest audited accounts of Standard Chartered Bank are available from its principal place of business in Jersey: PO Box 80, 15 Castle Street, St Helier, Jersey JE4 8PT. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter in 1853 Reference Number ZC 18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is also an authorised financial services provider under license number 44946 issued by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority of the Republic of South Africa. Jersey is not part of the United Kingdom and all business transacted with Standard Chartered Bank, Jersey Branch and other SC Group Entity outside of the United Kingdom, are not subject to some or any of the investor protection and compensation schemes available under United Kingdom law.

Kenya: This document is being distributed in Kenya by and is attributable to Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited. Investment Products and Services are distributed by Standard Chartered Investment Services Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited that is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority in Kenya, as a Fund Manager. Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited is regulated by the Central Bank of Kenya. **Malaysia:** This document is being distributed in Malaysia by Standard Chartered Bank Malaysia Berhad ("SCBMB"). Recipients in Malaysia should contact SCBMB in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. This document has not been reviewed by the Securities Commission Malaysia. The product lodgement, registration, submission or approval by the Securities Commission of Malaysia does not amount to nor indicate recommendation or endorsement of the product, service or promotional activity. Investment products are not deposits and are not obligations of, not guaranteed by, and not protected by SCBMB or any of the affiliates or subsidiaries, or by Perbadanan Insurans Deposit Malaysia, any government or insurance agency. Investment products are subject to investment risks, including the possible loss of the principal amount invested. SCBMB expressly disclaim any liability and responsibility for any loss arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) arising from the financial losses of the Investment Products due to market condition.

Nigeria: This document is being distributed in Nigeria by Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited (SCB Nigeria), a bank duly licensed and regulated by the Central Bank of Nigeria. SCB Nigeria accepts no liability for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to clientcare.ng@sc.com requesting to be removed from our mailing list. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 02 012772514 for any questions or service queries. SCB Nigeria shall not be responsible for any loss or damage arising from your decision to send confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail. SCB Nigeria makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail.

Pakistan: This document is being distributed in Pakistan by, and attributable to Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited having its registered office at PO Box 5556, I.I Chundrigar Road Karachi, which is a banking company registered with State Bank of Pakistan under Banking Companies Ordinance 1962 and is also having licensed issued by Securities & Exchange Commission of Pakistan for Security Advisors. Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited acts as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of other third-party financial products. **Singapore:** This document is being distributed in Singapore by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited (Registration No. 201224747C/ GST Group Registration No. MR-8500053-0, "SCBSL"). Recipients in Singapore should contact SCBSL in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. SCBSL is an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed to conduct banking business in Singapore under the Singapore Banking Act, 1970. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBSL. IN RELATION TO ANY SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT REFERRED TO IN THIS DOCUMENT, THIS DOCUMENT, TOGETHER WITH THE ISSUER DOCUMENTATION, SHALL BE DEEMED AN INFORMATION MEMORANDUM (AS DEFINED IN SECTION 275 OF THE SECURITIES AND FUTURES ACT, 2001 ("SFA")). THIS DOCUMENT IS INTENDED FOR DISTRIBUTION TO ACCREDITED INVESTORS, AS DEFINED IN SECTION



Disclosures

4A(1)(a) OF THE SFA, OR ON THE BASIS THAT THE SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT MAY ONLY BE ACQUIRED AT A CONSIDERATION OF NOT LESS THAN S\$200,000 (OR ITS EQUIVALENT IN A FOREIGN CURRENCY) FOR EACH TRANSACTION. Further, in relation to any security or securities-based derivatives contract, neither this document nor the Issuer Documentation has been registered as a prospectus with the Monetary Authority of Singapore under the SFA. Accordingly, this document and any other document or material in connection with the offer or sale, or invitation for subscription or purchase, of the product may not be circulated or distributed, nor may the product be offered or sold, or be made the subject of an invitation for subscription or purchase, whether directly or indirectly, to persons other than a relevant person pursuant to section 275(1) of the SFA, or any person pursuant to section 275(1A) of the SFA, and in accordance with the conditions specified in section 275 of the SFA, or pursuant to, and in accordance with the conditions of, any other applicable provision of the SFA. In relation to any collective investment schemes referred to in this document, this document is for general information purposes only and is not an offering document or prospectus (as defined in the SFA). This document is not, nor is it intended to be (i) an offer or solicitation of an offer to buy or sell any capital markets product; or (ii) an advertisement of an offer or intended offer of any capital markets product. Deposit Insurance Scheme: Singapore dollar deposits of non-bank depositors are insured by the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation, for up to S\$100,000 in aggregate per depositor per Scheme member by law. Foreign currency deposits, dual currency investments, structured deposits and other investment products are not insured. This advertisement has not been reviewed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. **Taiwan:** SC Group Entity or Standard Chartered Bank (Taiwan) Limited ("SCB (Taiwan)") may be involved in the financial instruments contained herein or other related financial instruments. The author of this document may have discussed the information contained herein with other employees or agents of SC or SCB (Taiwan). The author and the above-mentioned employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have taken related actions in respect of the information involved (including communication with customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) as to the information contained herein). The opinions contained in this document may change, or differ from the opinions of employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC and SCB (Taiwan) will not provide any notice of any changes to or differences between the above-mentioned opinions. This document may cover companies with which SC or SCB (Taiwan) seeks to do business at times and issuers of financial instruments. Therefore, investors should understand that the information contained herein may serve as specific purposes as a result of conflict of interests of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC, SCB (Taiwan), the employees (including those who have discussions with the author) or customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have an interest in the products, related financial instruments or related derivative financial products contained herein; invest in those products at various prices and on different market conditions; have different or conflicting interests in those products. The potential impacts include market makers' related activities, such as dealing, investment, acting as agents, or performing financial or consulting services in relation to any of the products referred to in this document. **UAE:** DIFC - Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered Bank, Dubai International Financial Centre having its offices at Dubai International Financial Centre, Building 1, Gate Precinct, P.O. Box 999, Dubai, UAE is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority ("DFSA"). This document is intended for use only by Professional Clients and is not directed at Retail Clients as defined by the DFSA Rulebook. In the DIFC we are authorised to provide financial services only to clients who qualify as Professional Clients and Market Counterparties and not to Retail Clients. As a Professional Client you will not be given the higher retail client protection and compensation rights and if you use your right to be classified as a Retail Client we will be unable to provide financial services and products to you as we do not hold the required license to undertake such activities. For Islamic transactions, we are acting under the supervision of our Shariah Supervisory Committee. Relevant information on our Shariah Supervisory Committee is currently available on the Standard Chartered Bank website in the Islamic banking section. For residents of the UAE – Standard Chartered UAE ("SC UAE") is licensed by the Central Bank of the U.A.E. SC UAE is licensed by Securities and Commodities Authority to practice Promotion Activity. SC UAE does not provide financial analysis or consultation services in or into the UAE within the meaning of UAE Securities and Commodities Authority Decision No. 48/r of 2008 concerning financial consultation and financial analysis. **Uganda:** Our Investment products and services are distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Uganda Limited, which is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority as an investment adviser. **United Kingdom:** In the UK, Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. This communication has been approved by Standard Chartered Bank for the purposes of Section 21 (2) (b) of the United Kingdom's Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 ("FSMA") as amended in 2010 and 2012 only. Standard Chartered Bank (trading as Standard Chartered Private Bank) is also an authorised financial services provider (license number 45747) in terms of the South African Financial Advisory and Intermediary Services Act, 2002. The Materials have not been prepared in accordance with UK legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research, and that it is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research. **Vietnam:** This document is being distributed in Vietnam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited which is mainly regulated by State Bank of Vietnam (SBV). Recipients in Vietnam should contact Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited for any queries regarding any content of this document. **Zambia:** This document is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Zambia Plc, a company incorporated in Zambia and registered as a commercial bank and licensed by the Bank of Zambia under the Banking and Financial Services Act Chapter 387 of the Laws of Zambia.

PUBLIC



standard
chartered

Investing in “Global Tech”

March 2026



WS Global CIO Office

Editor-in-Chief

Steve Brice

Global Chief Investment Officer

Authors

**Sundeep Gantori, CFA,
CAIA**

Chief Investment Officer,
Equities

Fook Hien Yap

Senior Investment Strategist

Michelle Kam, CFA

Investment Strategist

Jason Wong

Equity Analyst

Contents

03	Foreword
04	The case to invest in Global Tech
08	Why active management in Global Tech is more rewarding?
13	The SCB framework to invest in Global Tech
15	Staying the course and conclusions

Foreword

Dear Reader,

Welcome to our white paper on Investing in “Global Tech”, where we explore the transformative trends shaping the global investment landscape over the coming years – and decades. We keep our spotlight throughout on the enduring appeal, and necessary evolution of **Global Tech**, which we define as tech and tech-enabled business models as represented by a growth benchmark index. We believe the theme is a core pillar of global asset allocation, representing around 20% of our CIO Foundation Balanced portfolio spanning tech and tech-enabled sectors expanding at an above average pace.

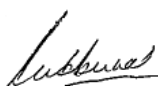
We are living in an era of extraordinary imagination. Rapid advances in generative AI have moved beyond being a purely structural theme to become a pervasive force – much as internet-enabled devices did in prior decades. While early signs of AI-driven disruption became evident as early as the first quarter of 2026, we remain firmly in the “glass half full” camp. In our view, AI presents far more opportunities than risks. The world has found a new growth engine – one capable of unlocking unprecedented investment opportunities – and this reinforces **Global Tech** as one of the key pillars in driving long-term portfolio returns.

Our back-testing shows that the Global Tech theme as represented by a growth benchmark index has historically been rewarding for investors, delivering consistent outperformance versus the other style, value. We see no reason for this to change. As innovation accelerates and competitive advantages widen, markets are likely to continue rewarding business models with superior and durable growth prospects.

Capturing these opportunities, however, requires a disciplined and systematic approach. Investing in tech and tech-enabled business models today goes beyond passive exposure; it demands active management to navigate market volatility, business cycles, and disruption risks. We address these dynamics through the **SCB framework to invest in Global Tech**, which identifies three broad opportunity sets and explicitly right-sizes exposure across them:

- **Structural opportunities (S):** Secular business models offering long-term visibility with strong compounding potential.
- **Cyclical opportunities (C):** Tactical opportunities arising from valuation mismatches and demand-supply imbalances as industries and regions embrace innovation at different speeds.
- **Binary opportunities (B):** Select turnaround as well as moonshot opportunities linked to next frontier technologies that offer optionality through an asymmetric risk-reward profile.

The future is arriving faster than ever. It is imperative that investors and leaders work hand in hand to embrace both the opportunities and challenges of this new era to forge a resilient and prosperous path forward. We hope this report provides the insights and framework needed to navigate what we believe is a rewarding – and defining – Global Tech investment landscape.



Samir Subberwal

Global Head, Wealth Solutions, Retail Products, Data & Analytics

The case to invest in Global Tech



Our Global Tech investment theme is firmly anchored in a growth style approach, where we place greater emphasis on tech and tech-enabled business models that can offer structural earnings growth prospects.

This does not imply that valuation is irrelevant for growth companies; rather, on a relative basis, earnings growth is the dominant driver of long-term market returns.

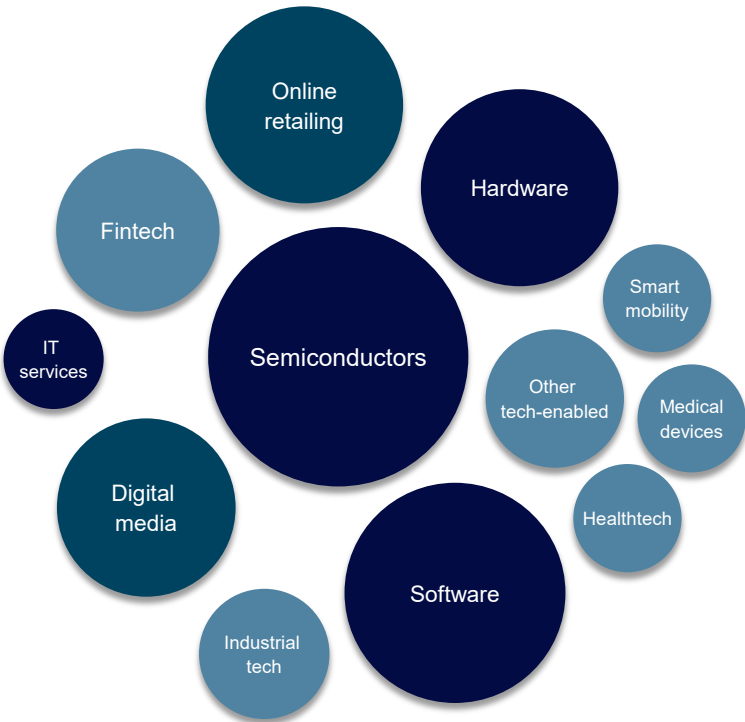
For us, Global Tech includes both tech and tech-enabled business models, which accounts for roughly 40% of global equities or put differently from an asset allocation point of view, the theme represents around 20% of our CIO Foundation Balanced portfolio. Relative to the other investment style—global value—our Global Tech theme is focused on growth companies operating in sectors that typically trade at valuation premiums. These premiums, in our view, are justified by above average and more durable growth prospects.

Companies within our Global Tech universe are predominantly found in tech and tech-enabled sectors such as IT, communication services, consumer discretionary, and industries such as fintech, healthtech etc. coupled with other innovation driven segments spanning both the new and old economy. A clear example is the renewed growth visibility in traditionally cyclical sectors such as industrials and utilities, supported by unprecedented AI related capital expenditure. Put simply, our Global Tech theme focuses on companies with tech and tech-enabled business models that can offer superior and sustainable growth trajectories.

Fig. 1

What is included in Global Tech?

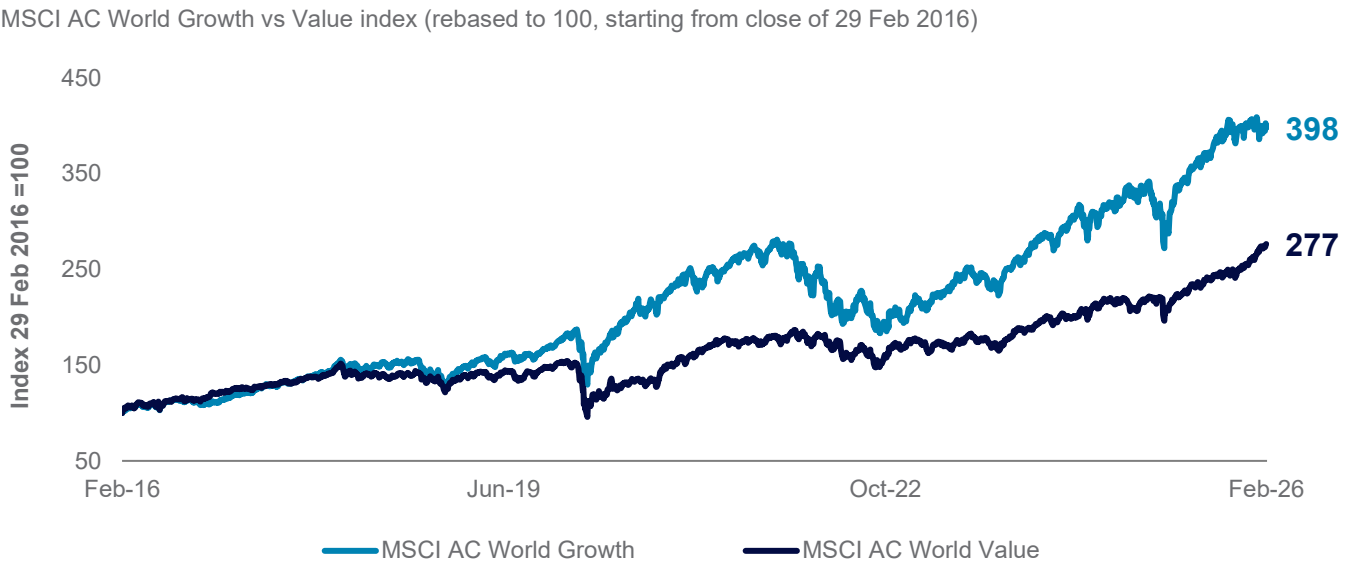
Tech and Tech-enabled industries are spread across sectors with the size of bubble representing addressable market capitalisation in our view



Source:Standard Chartered

From a performance perspective, Global Tech theme as represented by the growth benchmark index has delivered compelling results. Over the past decade (2016–2025), the theme generated average annual returns of 14.8%, compared with 10.7% for the value style (both based on MSCI indices). This outperformance has been driven primarily by superior earnings growth, typically in the low-to-mid-teens, while valuation premiums have remained broadly intact over the period.

Fig. 2
Despite premium valuations, Global Tech has outperformed global value over the past decade



Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

Looking ahead, we believe the investment backdrop for Global Tech remains constructive. We expect strong revenue growth and resilient margin profiles to continue supporting superior earnings growth. While AI (artificial intelligence) will play a central role in expanding addressable markets for leading technology companies, innovation is far from confined to a single sector like IT. Areas such as consumer discretionary, digital media healthcare and fintech, that are represented across sectors, continue to see rapid product innovation and adoption, underpinning broad-based revenue momentum across our Global Tech universe. At the same time, steady margin trends – supported by pricing power, automation, and operational efficiencies – should sustain 10-15% earnings growth p.a. over the foreseeable future. Although near-term indicators capture only part of this picture, consensus earnings forecasts for 2026 and 2027 clearly show Global Tech-oriented sectors in the driver’s seat.

Fig. 3
Superior earnings growth will likely support the performance of Global Tech

Earnings growth forecast for global sectors in 2026 and 2027



Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

While Global Tech continues to trade at a valuation premium relative to value, we believe this premium is warranted. On average, Global Tech offers 10-15% earnings growth p.a., compared with 6-9% earnings growth p.a. for global value counterparts – a differential that supports the valuation gap.

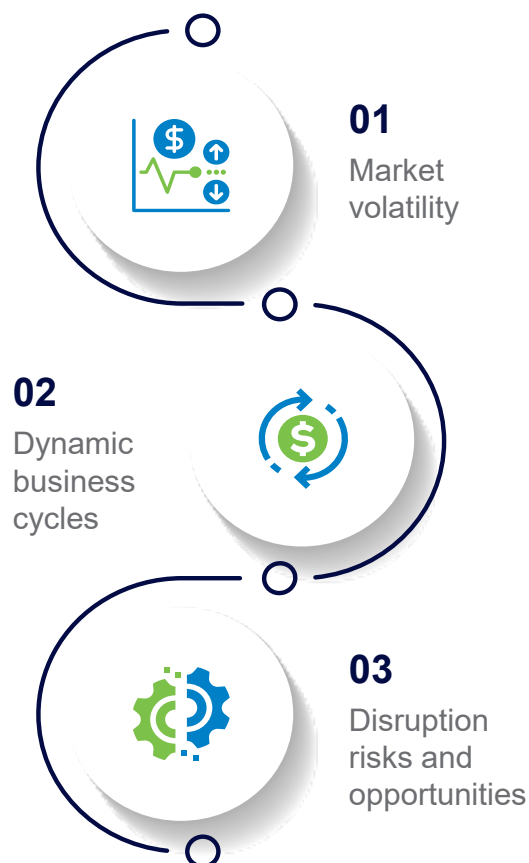
Against this backdrop, we see a favourable and durable backdrop for the Global Tech theme in the years ahead. Importantly, however, we believe the strongest case for outperformance lies in an active investment approach, rather than passive exposure. The dynamic and disruptive nature of once in a generation forces such as AI is likely to amplify market volatility, shorten business cycles, and drive disruption. Active management is therefore essential to navigate these shifts effectively – a topic we explore further in the next chapter.

Why active management in Global Tech is more rewarding?

While we maintain our conviction in the structural outperformance of Global Tech over value as a long-term theme, we see a more compelling risk-reward profile in adopting an active approach over passive investing.

This stems from the inherently dynamic nature of tech investing, where business models must continuously adapt to rapid innovation cycles. As the saying goes, “the only constant is change.” In this environment, actively rebalancing portfolios to reflect evolving fundamentals can help investors manage significant drawdowns while positioning for emerging opportunities at key inflection points.

Three key developments reinforce our case for active management in Global Tech:





Let's begin with market volatility. Despite delivering above-average returns over the past decade, the Global Tech theme has experienced frequent drawdowns. This is not surprising given the innovative nature of its constituents, which are often exposed to idiosyncratic risks such as regulatory shifts, product cycles, leadership changes, or supply chain disruptions. Fig. 4, shows the number of 5% and above drawdowns for Global Tech, as represented by growth benchmark index over the past decade.

Fig. 4

Global Tech theme experienced multiple drawdowns over the past decade

Drawdowns of at least 5% for MSCI AC World Growth Index between 2016-2025



Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

However, these drawdowns have historically presented attractive entry points and not reasons to panic. As shown in Fig. 5, the Global Tech as represented by growth benchmark index has consistently rebounded strongly over the subsequent 6 months after frequent drawdowns. This underscores the value of an active approach – one that distinguishes between short-term noise and long-term fundamentals, enabling investors to capitalise on volatility rather than be derailed by it.

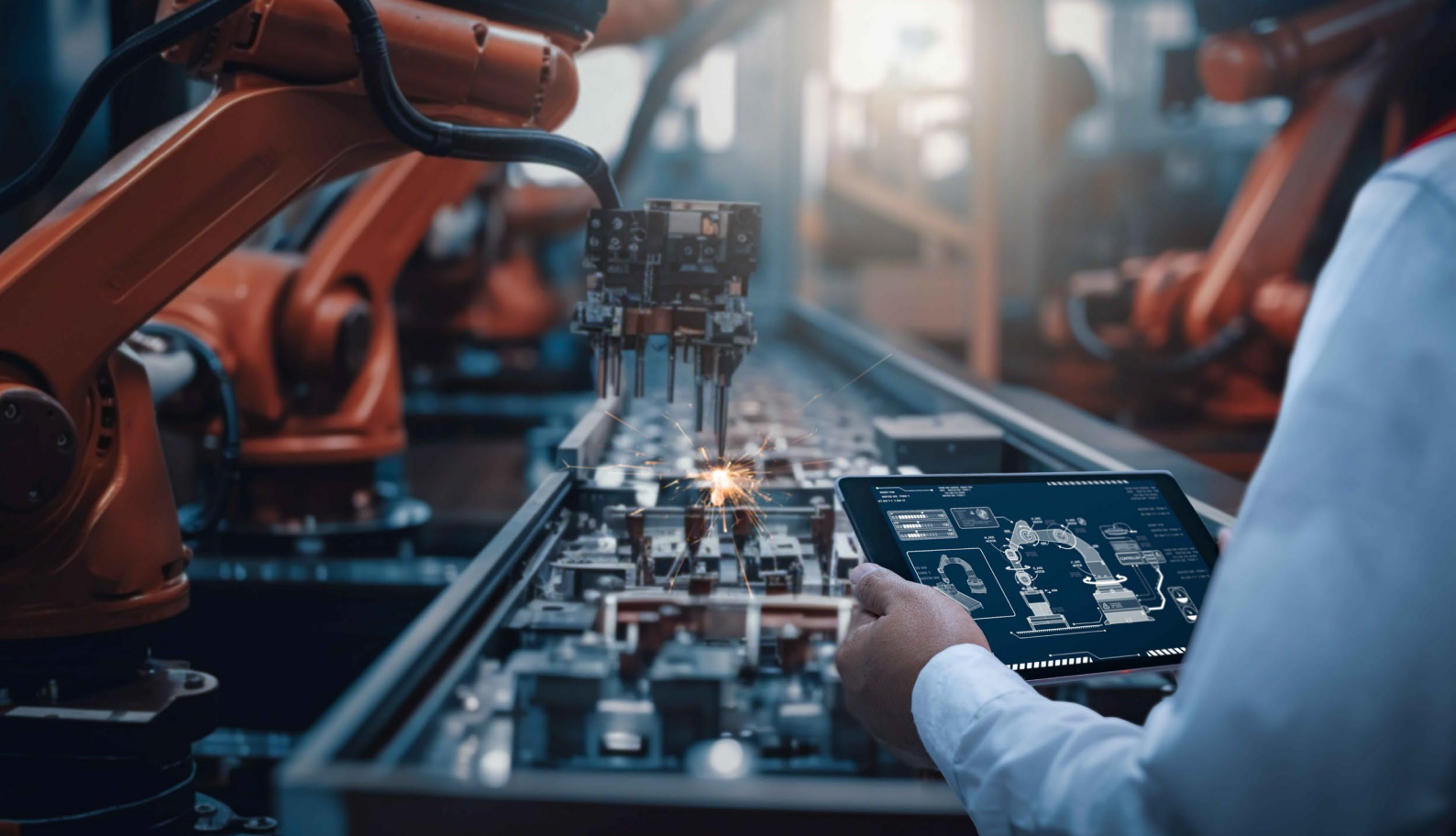
Fig. 5

Global Tech stocks rebounded historically after a sharp decline

6-month rebound in MSCI AC World Growth Index after frequent drawdowns over the past decade

Peak	Trough	Days (Peak to Trough)	6m return after the trough
01 Jan 2016	11 Feb 2016	41	20.4%
08 Jun 2016	27 Jun 2016	19	8.3%
07 Sep 2016	04 Nov 2016	58	15.5%
26 Jan 2018	08 Feb 2018	13	8.5%
29 Aug 2018	25 Dec 2018	118	25.2%
03 May 2019	03 Jun 2019	31	13.4%
26 Jul 2019	05 Aug 2019	10	19.2%
19 Feb 2020	23 Mar 2020	33	55.5%
02 Sep 2020	24 Sept 2020	22	15.5%
15 Feb 2021	08 Mar 2021	21	20.5%
26 Apr 2021	13 May 2021	17	17.3%
07 Sep 2021	04 Oct 2021	27	-0.5%
19 Nov 2021	14 Oct 2022	329	22.7%
21 Mar 2024	19 Apr 2024	29	18.4%
10 Jul 2024	05 Aug 2024	26	19.4%
16 Dec 2024	14 Jan 2025	29	11.5%
18 Feb 2025	08 Apr 2025	49	45.1%
29 Oct 2025	21 Nov 2025	23	–
Average			19.8%

Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

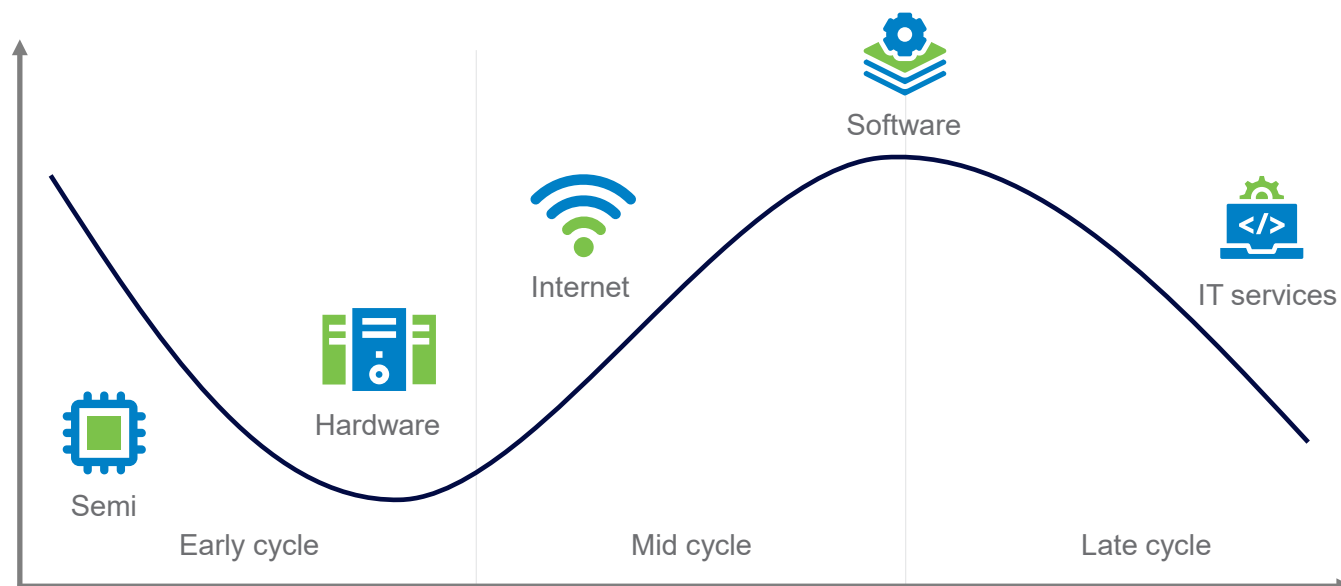


The second pillar of our argument is the importance of navigating business cycles within Global Tech's diverse segments. For instance, within the tech sector, five key industries – semiconductors, hardware, internet, software, and IT services – tend to perform differently depending on the stage of the business cycle. Our “Tech Industry Playbook” (see Fig. 6) shows that semiconductors and hardware typically lead in early-cycle recoveries, followed by internet and software in the mid-cycle, and IT services in the late cycle.

Fig. 6

Tech Industry Playbook to navigate across the business cycle

Positioning across five industries based on the business cycle is key to generate alpha



Source: Standard Chartered

Against this backdrop, active approaches that can correctly identify the business cycle and apply industry playbooks—by overweighting or underweighting specific sub-segments—can help generate alpha. For instance, the Tech industry playbook is also working effectively even during the ongoing AI cycle. With AI still in its early innings, semiconductors and internet companies have outperformed, while software and IT services – typically mid-to-late cycle beneficiaries – have lagged. We believe playbooks such as these remain valuable tools for identifying inflection points and adjusting allocations accordingly. It is also worth noting that tech sub-cycles vary in duration, requiring nimble positioning.

Lastly, active management is essential in navigating disruption risks – an inherent feature of the Global Tech theme. As discussed earlier, innovation is both a driver and a disruptor for the theme. Understanding evolving business models and proactively managing disruption risk can help investors stay focused and avoid emotionally driven decisions. For example, Fig. 7 compares the 10-year performance of retail companies, Amazon and Walmart. While both companies delivered largely similar returns over the full period, the journey was markedly different. In the first half, online retailer Amazon’s dominance in e-commerce weighed heavily on traditional retailers like Walmart. However, as incumbents adapted and embraced digital transformation, they regained investor confidence and narrowed the performance gap eventually. Understanding at which stage of the disruption cycle and active adjustment of portfolios is also key to generate alpha within the Global Tech theme.

Fig. 7
Case study: Amazon and Walmart share prices evolved at different paces



Source: Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

To summarise, we believe that active management is not just preferable but essential when investing in the dynamic Global Tech theme. By actively managing volatility, navigating sector and industry cycles, and managing disruption risks, investors can enhance returns and mitigate downside risks more effectively than through a passive approach.

The SCB framework to invest in Global Tech

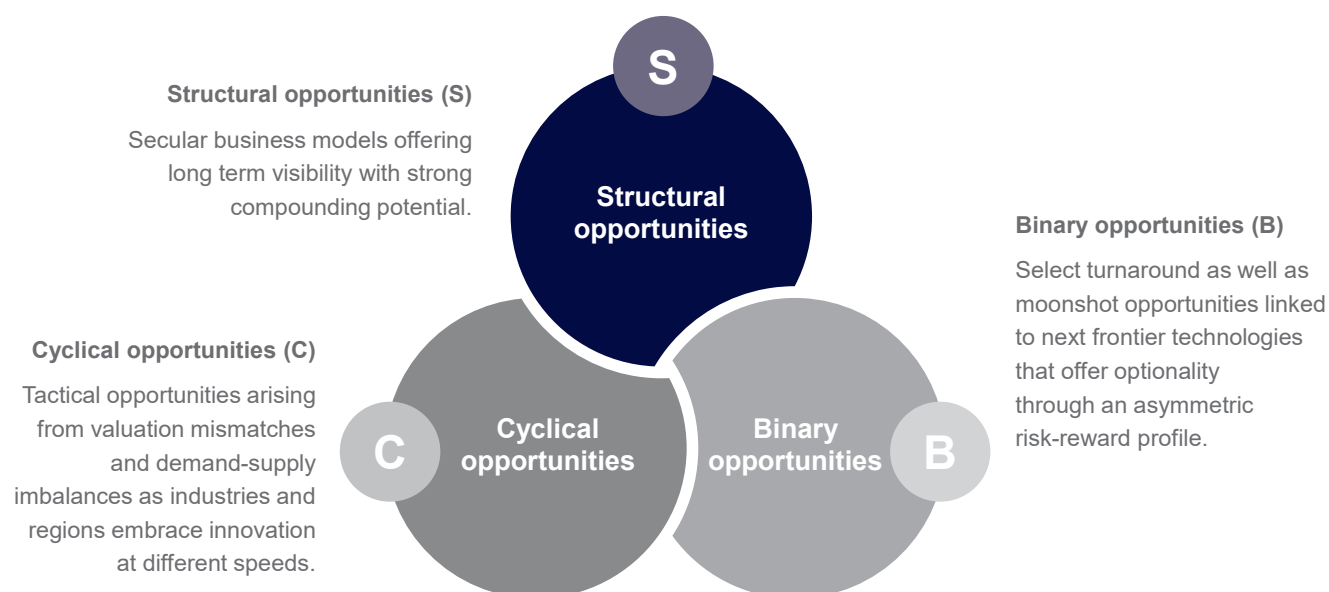
With active management chosen as the preferred approach to investing in Global Tech, how should investors select the right business models within a portfolio context?

This is a fair question, given that most companies in the Global Tech universe typically report above average earnings growth, so there needs to be some form of differentiation. As a result, it becomes imperative not only to segment companies into distinct buckets, but also to right-size exposures from a portfolio construction perspective.

To help investors navigate this challenge, we introduce the **SCB framework** for investing in Global Tech. Under this framework, Global Tech companies are categorised into three buckets: **Structural opportunities (S)**, **Cyclical opportunities (C)** and **Binary opportunities (B)**.

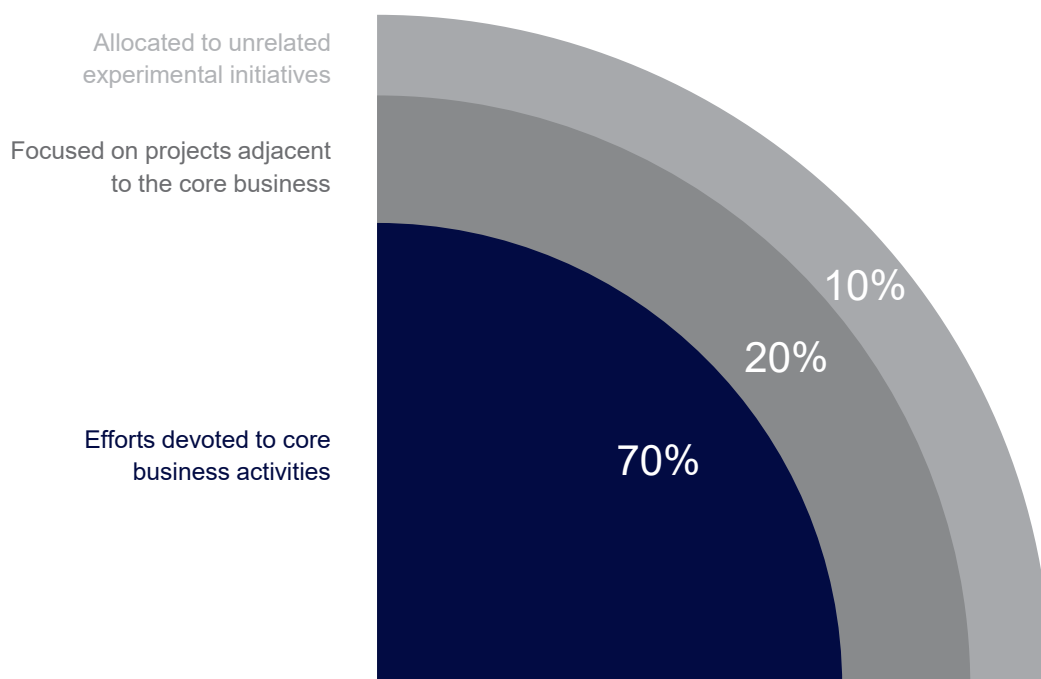
Fig. 8

The SCB framework to invest in Global Tech



Source: Standard Chartered

In thinking about how to right size these three buckets, we draw inspiration from the 70-20-10 rule of innovation, popularised by Google, which seeks to optimise resource allocation as follows:



In a similar spirit, we believe the **70-20-10 rule** is well suited to Global Tech portfolios. While our intention is not to rigidly define or constrain portfolio allocations to precise limits, the underlying principles provide a useful framework for investors. By embracing flexibility rather than strict thresholds, we see greater scope for alpha generation, particularly when this framework is combined with complementary approaches.

For example, overlaying the **70-20-10 innovation framework** with our **Tech Industry Playbook** allows investors to right size positions across segments. Within semiconductors, logic and foundry can be viewed as **structural** exposures, memory as **cyclical**, and areas such as quantum computing as **binary** opportunities. Similarly, within software, horizontal software companies tend to be **structural**, vertical software companies more **cyclical**, and emerging agentic software companies, mostly **binary** in nature.

Against this backdrop, without being overly rigid and by applying the 70-20-10 rule in spirit, we believe that **approximately 70% of a Global Tech portfolio** can be allocated to **Structural opportunities**. The objective of this bucket is to defend the portfolio while compounding returns through companies with proven business models, strong margins, robust cash flow generation and sound corporate governance. Examples include platform companies with dominant industry positions across technology, healthcare and fintech. Given the compounding objective, the investment horizon for structural opportunities should be long-term.

Approximately **20% allocation** in our view should be directed towards **Cyclical opportunities** – companies benefiting from strong cyclical tailwinds driven by near-term valuation mismatches or demand supply imbalances. Unlike structural opportunities, these companies are often product centric (rather than platform based) or tier 2 players within their respective industries. As the primary objective is to capture near-term value, the investment horizon for cyclical opportunities is typically shorter, often **less than one year**.

Finally, roughly remaining **10% allocation** should, in our view, be reserved for **Binary opportunities** that offer asymmetric risk-reward profiles. These include potential turnarounds within fallen angels as well as investments in frontier or moonshot technologies that may not yet be commercially viable but possess the potential for exponential growth. Turnaround opportunities can emerge across market capitalisation segments and are typically driven by the prospect of structural mean reversion. Moonshot opportunities may include areas such as space technologies, neural interfaces, autonomous driving and quantum computing. While the investment horizon in this bucket is less prescriptive given the primary objective is to unlock asymmetric risk-reward profiles, disciplined risk management – such as the use of strict stop loss frameworks – is critical here.

In conclusion, we believe that a clear understanding of business models, effective segmentation into the right opportunity buckets, and disciplined right sizing of allocations are essential to generating **sustainable alpha** within Global Tech portfolios.

Staying the course and conclusions

With active management in place and the SCB framework guiding our approach to Global Tech, the next obvious question is whether investors should be mindful of additional idiosyncrasies when investing in the theme.

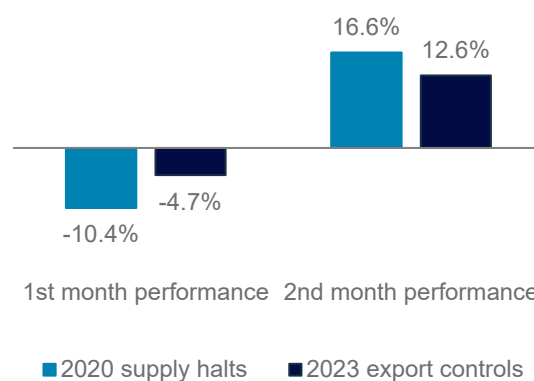
Given the dynamic news flow and the many innovative forces shaping Global Tech, investors require subject matter expertise to navigate the space effectively and generate alpha. As such, we believe professional managers are well equipped to actively manage Global Tech portfolios, particularly as they are better positioned to manage the behavioural aspects of investing in volatile segments such as tech or tech-enabled business models. The key is to stay invested, avoid being swayed by short-term volatility, and not be driven by emotional decision making – areas where professional managers can add meaningful value.

Take, for example, frequent supply chain disruptions in tech business models. A typical investor response is often to sell affected stocks, whereas a professional manager with a deeper understanding of supply chains and their many moving parts is less likely to overreact. As illustrated in the figure on the right, while the Global Tech theme initially suffered during the first month of supply disruptions, it rebounded strongly in the second month as risks appeared manageable. Remaining invested throughout, rather than selling low and buying back higher, would have been the more effective approach.

Fig. 9

Global Tech's performance during recent supply chain disruptions

First and second month performance of MSCI AC World Growth after 2020 supply halts and 2023 export controls



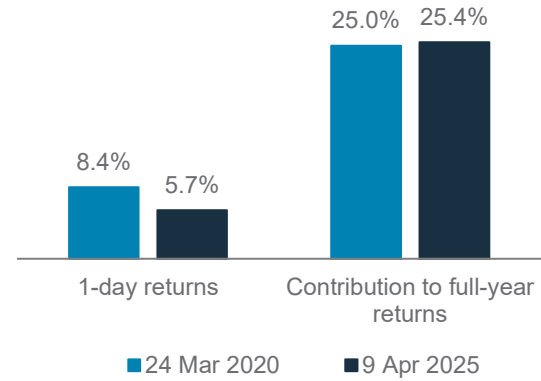
Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered

Another illustration of why staying invested matters can be seen in Fig. 10, which highlights the two best single day returns for the Global Tech theme over the past decade. Notably, these two days accounted for nearly 25% of the full year returns in their respective years. What is particularly striking is that these gains were generated during periods of heightened uncertainty (around peak COVID related stress in 2020 and around Liberation Day in 2025). Once again, this reinforces the importance of staying invested, and our view that professional managers are better equipped to navigate such environments.

Staying invested does not mean ignoring risks – this is not our message. Rather, we believe robust risk management is essential to preparing for both idiosyncratic risks, such as innovation, disruption, management changes and supply chain challenges, as well as systemic risks related to inflation, interest rates and geopolitics. For instance, Global Tech underperformed value in 2022 amid rising interest rates and heightened geopolitical tensions. However, the emergence of the ChatGPT app and generative AI use cases towards the end of that year reaffirmed that innovation remains firmly in the driving seat.

Fig. 10
The case for staying invested in Global Tech

Two best daily returns for Global Tech over the past decade accounted for roughly a quarter of that year's total returns



Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, Standard Chartered



In summary, with Global Tech a key pillar of global asset allocation, representing around 20% of the CIO Foundation portfolio, investors must recognise the strategic importance of the theme and avoid complacency at a time when disruptive technologies such as AI are fundamentally reshaping the investment landscape. We believe that active management – anchored by clear frameworks and a disciplined commitment to staying invested – can make Global Tech a highly rewarding long-term opportunity. Over time, investors stand to benefit from the compounding power of business models with above average and durable growth prospects.

For more details on how to invest in Global Tech, please contact your Standard Chartered representative.



Disclosures

This document is confidential and may also be privileged. If you are not the intended recipient, please destroy all copies and notify the sender immediately. This document is being distributed for general information only and is subject to the relevant disclaimers available at our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures. It is not and does not constitute research material, independent research, an offer, recommendation or solicitation to enter into any transaction or adopt any hedging, trading or investment strategy, in relation to any securities or other financial instruments. This document is for general evaluation only. It does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs of any particular person or class of persons and it has not been prepared for any particular person or class of persons. You should not rely on any contents of this document in making any investment decisions. Before making any investment, you should carefully read the relevant offering documents and seek independent legal, tax and regulatory advice. In particular, we recommend you to seek advice regarding the suitability of the investment product, taking into account your specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs, before you make a commitment to purchase the investment product. Opinions, projections and estimates are solely those of SC at the date of this document and subject to change without notice. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. The value of investments, and the income from them, can go down as well as up, and you may not recover the amount of your original investment. You are not certain to make a profit and may lose money. Any forecast contained herein as to likely future movements in rates or prices or likely future events or occurrences constitutes an opinion only and is not indicative of actual future movements in rates or prices or actual future events or occurrences (as the case may be). This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of the Standard Chartered Group (as defined below). Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered PLC, the ultimate parent company of Standard Chartered Bank, together with its subsidiaries and affiliates (including each branch or representative office), form the Standard Chartered Group. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of Standard Chartered. Private banking activities may be carried out internationally by different legal entities and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group (each an "SC Group Entity") according to local regulatory requirements. Not all products and services are provided by all branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group. Some of the SC Group Entities only act as representatives of Standard Chartered Private Bank and may not be able to offer products and services or offer advice to clients.

Copyright © 2026, Accounting Research & Analytics, LLC d/b/a CFRA (and its affiliates, as applicable). Reproduction of content provided by CFRA in any form is prohibited except with the prior written permission of CFRA. CFRA content is not investment advice and a reference to or observation concerning a security or investment provided in the CFRA SERVICES is not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold such investment or security or make any other investment decisions. The CFRA content contains opinions of CFRA based upon publicly-available information that CFRA believes to be reliable and the opinions are subject to change without notice. This analysis has not been submitted to, nor received approval from, the United States Securities and Exchange Commission or any other regulatory body. While CFRA exercised due care in compiling this analysis, CFRA, ITS THIRD-PARTY SUPPLIERS, AND ALL RELATED ENTITIES SPECIFICALLY DISCLAIM ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, ANY WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE OR USE, to the full extent permitted by law, regarding the accuracy, completeness, or usefulness of this information and assumes no liability with respect to the consequences of relying on this information for investment or other purposes. No content provided by CFRA (including ratings, credit-related analyses and data, valuations, model, software or other application or output therefrom) or any part thereof may be modified, reverse engineered, reproduced or distributed in any form by any means, or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of CFRA, and such content shall not be used for any unlawful or unauthorized purposes. CFRA and any third-party providers, as well as their directors, officers, shareholders, employees or agents do not guarantee the accuracy, completeness, timeliness or availability of such content. In no event shall CFRA, its affiliates, or their third-party suppliers be liable for any direct, indirect, special, or consequential damages, costs, expenses, legal fees, or losses (including lost income or lost profit and opportunity costs) in connection with a subscriber's, subscriber's customer's, or other's use of CFRA's content.

Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) Disclaimer

Banking activities may be carried out internationally by different branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group according to local regulatory requirements. Opinions may contain outright "buy", "sell", "hold" or other opinions. The time horizon of this opinion is dependent on prevailing market conditions and there is no planned frequency for updates to the opinion. This opinion is not independent of Standard Chartered Group's trading strategies or positions. Standard Chartered Group and/or its affiliates or its respective officers, directors, employee benefit programmes or employees, including persons involved in the preparation or issuance of this document may at any time, to the extent permitted by applicable law and/or regulation, be long or short any securities or financial instruments referred to in this document or have material interest in any such securities or related investments. Therefore, it is possible, and you should assume, that Standard Chartered Group has a material interest in one or more of the financial instruments mentioned herein. Please refer to our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures for more detailed disclosures, including past opinions/ recommendations in the last 12 months and conflict of interests, as well as disclaimers. A covering strategist may have a financial interest in the debt or equity securities of

this company/issuer. All covering strategists are licensed to provide investment recommendations under Monetary Authority of Singapore or Hong Kong Monetary Authority. This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of Standard Chartered Group.

Sustainable Investments

Any ESG data used or referred to has been provided by Morningstar, Sustainalytics, MSCI or Bloomberg. Refer to 1) Morningstar website under Sustainable Investing, 2) Sustainalytics website under ESG Risk Ratings, 3) MSCI website under ESG Business Involvement Screening Research and 4) Bloomberg green, social & sustainability bonds guide for more information. The ESG data is as at the date of publication based on data provided, is for informational purpose only and is not warranted to be complete, timely, accurate or suitable for a particular purpose, and it may be subject to change. Sustainable Investments (SI): This refers to funds that have been classified as 'ESG Intentional Investments - Overall' by Morningstar. SI funds have explicitly stated in their prospectus and regulatory filings that they either incorporate ESG factors into the investment process or have a thematic focus on the environment, gender diversity, low carbon, renewable energy, water or community development. For equity, it refers to shares/stocks issued by companies with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible. For bonds, it refers to debt instruments issued by issuers with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible, and/or those being certified green, social, sustainable bonds by Bloomberg. For structured products, it refers to products that are issued by any issuer who has a Sustainable Finance framework that aligns with Standard Chartered's Green and Sustainable Product Framework, with underlying assets that are part of the Sustainable Investment universe or separately approved by Standard Chartered's Sustainable Finance Governance Committee. Sustainalytics ESG risk ratings shown are factual and are not an indicator that the product is classified or marketed as "green", "sustainable" or similar under any particular classification system or framework.

Country/Market Specific Disclosures

Bahrain: This document is being distributed in Bahrain by Standard Chartered Bank, Bahrain Branch, having its address at P.O. 29, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain, is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed by the Central Bank of Bahrain as a conventional retail bank. **Botswana:** This document is being distributed in Botswana by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank Botswana Limited which is a financial institution licensed under the Section 6 of the Banking Act CAP 46:04 and is listed in the Botswana Stock Exchange. **Brunei Darussalam:** This document is being distributed in Brunei Darussalam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Brunei Branch) | Registration Number RFC/61 and Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd | Registration Number RC20001003. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd is a limited liability company registered with the Registry of Companies with Registration Number RC20001003 and licensed by Brunei Darussalam Central Bank as a Capital Markets Service License Holder with License Number BDCB/R/CMU/S3-CL and it is authorised to conduct Islamic investment business through an Islamic window. **China Mainland:** This document is being distributed in China by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (China) Limited which is mainly regulated by National Financial Regulatory Administration (NFRA), State Administration of Foreign Exchange (SAFE), and People's Bank of China (PBOC). **Hong Kong:** In Hong Kong, this document, except for any portion advising on or facilitating any decision on futures contracts trading, is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("SCBHK"), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. SCBHK has its registered address at 32/F, Standard Chartered Bank Building, 4-4A Des Voeux Road Central, Hong Kong and is regulated by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority and registered with the Securities and Futures Commission ("SFC") to carry on Type 1 (dealing in securities), Type 4 (advising on securities), Type 6 (advising on corporate finance) and Type 9 (asset management) regulated activity under the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571) ("SFO") (CE No. AJL614). The contents of this document have not been reviewed by any regulatory authority in Hong Kong and you are advised to exercise caution in relation to any offer set out herein. If you are in doubt about any of the contents of this document, you should obtain independent professional advice. Any product named herein may not be offered or sold in Hong Kong by means of any document at any time other than to "professional investors" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance. In addition, this document may not be issued or possessed for the purposes of issue, whether in Hong Kong or elsewhere, and any interests may not be disposed of, to any person unless such person is outside Hong Kong or is a "professional investor" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance, or as otherwise may be permitted by that ordinance. In Hong Kong, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBHK, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. **Ghana:** Standard Chartered Bank Ghana Limited accepts no liability and will not be liable for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to feedback.ghana@sc.com. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 0302610750 for any questions or service queries. You are advised not to send any confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail, as Standard Chartered makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. Standard Chartered shall not be responsible for any loss or damage suffered by you arising from your decision to use e-mail to communicate with the Bank. **India:** This document is being distributed in India by Standard Chartered in its capacity as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of any other third party financial products. Standard Chartered does not offer any 'Investment Advice' as defined in the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013 or otherwise. Services/products related securities business offered by Standard Chartered are not intended for any person, who is a resident of any jurisdiction, the laws of which imposes

prohibition on soliciting the securities business in that jurisdiction without going through the registration requirements and/or prohibit the use of any information contained in this document. **Indonesia:** This document is being distributed in Indonesia by Standard Chartered Bank, Indonesia branch, which is a financial institution licensed and supervised by Otoritas Jasa Keuangan (Financial Service Authority) and Bank Indonesia. **Jersey:** In Jersey, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the Registered Business Name of the Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is regulated by the Jersey Financial Services Commission. Copies of the latest audited accounts of Standard Chartered Bank are available from its principal place of business in Jersey: PO Box 80, 15 Castle Street, St Helier, Jersey JE4 8PT. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter in 1853 Reference Number ZC 18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is also an authorised financial services provider under license number 44946 issued by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority of the Republic of South Africa. Jersey is not part of the United Kingdom and all business transacted with Standard Chartered Bank, Jersey Branch and other SC Group Entity outside of the United Kingdom, are not subject to some or any of the investor protection and compensation schemes available under United Kingdom law. **Kenya:** This document is being distributed in Kenya by and is attributable to Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited. Investment Products and Services are distributed by Standard Chartered Investment Services Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited that is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority in Kenya, as a Fund Manager. Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited is regulated by the Central Bank of Kenya. **Malaysia:** This document is being distributed in Malaysia by Standard Chartered Bank Malaysia Berhad ("SCBMB"). Recipients in Malaysia should contact SCBMB in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. This document has not been reviewed by the Securities Commission Malaysia. The product lodgement, registration, submission or approval by the Securities Commission of Malaysia does not amount to nor indicate recommendation or endorsement of the product, service or promotional activity. Investment products are not deposits and are not obligations of, not guaranteed by, and not protected by SCBMB or any of the affiliates or subsidiaries, or by Perbadanan Insurans Deposit Malaysia, any government or insurance agency. Investment products are subject to investment risks, including the possible loss of the principal amount invested. SCBMB expressly disclaim any liability and responsibility for any loss arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) arising from the financial losses of the Investment Products due to market condition. **Nigeria:** This document is being distributed in Nigeria by Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited (SCB Nigeria), a bank duly licensed and regulated by the Central Bank of Nigeria. SCB Nigeria accepts no liability for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to clientcare.ng@sc.com requesting to be removed from our mailing list. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 02 012772514 for any questions or service queries. SCB Nigeria shall not be responsible for any loss or damage arising from your decision to send confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail. SCB Nigeria makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. **Pakistan:** This document is being distributed in Pakistan by, and attributable to Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited having its registered office at PO Box 5556, I.I Chundrigar Road Karachi, which is a banking company registered with State Bank of Pakistan under Banking Companies Ordinance 1962 and is also having licensed issued by Securities & Exchange Commission of Pakistan for Security Advisors. Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited acts as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of other third-party financial products. **Singapore:** This document is being distributed in Singapore by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited (Registration No. 201224747C/ GST Group Registration No. MR-8500053-0, "SCBSL"). Recipients in Singapore should contact SCBSL in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. SCBSL is an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed to conduct banking business in Singapore under the Singapore Banking Act, 1970. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBSL. IN RELATION TO ANY SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT REFERRED TO IN THIS DOCUMENT, THIS DOCUMENT, TOGETHER WITH THE ISSUER DOCUMENTATION, SHALL BE DEEMED AN INFORMATION MEMORANDUM (AS DEFINED IN SECTION 275 OF THE SECURITIES AND FUTURES ACT, 2001 ("SFA")). THIS DOCUMENT IS INTENDED FOR DISTRIBUTION TO ACCREDITED INVESTORS, AS DEFINED IN SECTION 4A(1)(a) OF THE SFA, OR ON THE BASIS THAT THE SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT MAY ONLY BE ACQUIRED AT A CONSIDERATION OF NOT LESS THAN S\$200,000 (OR ITS EQUIVALENT IN A FOREIGN CURRENCY) FOR EACH TRANSACTION. Further, in relation to any security or securities-based derivatives contract, neither this document nor the Issuer Documentation has been registered as a prospectus with the Monetary Authority of Singapore under the SFA. Accordingly, this document and any other document or material in connection with the offer or sale, or invitation for subscription or purchase, of the product may not be circulated or distributed, nor may the product be offered or sold, or be made the subject of an invitation for subscription or purchase, whether directly or indirectly, to persons other than a relevant person pursuant to section 275(1) of the SFA, or any person pursuant to section 275(1A) of the SFA, and in accordance with the conditions specified in section 275 of the SFA, or pursuant to, and in accordance with the conditions of, any other applicable provision of the SFA. In relation to any collective investment schemes referred to in this document, this document is for general information purposes only and is not an offering document or prospectus (as defined in the SFA). This document is not, nor is it intended to be (i) an offer or solicitation of an offer to buy or sell any capital markets product; or (ii) an advertisement of an offer or intended offer of any capital markets product. Deposit Insurance Scheme: Singapore dollar deposits of non-bank depositors are insured by the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation, for up to

S\$100,000 in aggregate per depositor per Scheme member by law. Foreign currency deposits, dual currency investments, structured deposits and other investment products are not insured. This advertisement has not been reviewed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. **Taiwan:** SC Group Entity or Standard Chartered Bank (Taiwan) Limited ("SCB (Taiwan)") may be involved in the financial instruments contained herein or other related financial instruments. The author of this document may have discussed the information contained herein with other employees or agents of SC or SCB (Taiwan). The author and the above-mentioned employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have taken related actions in respect of the information involved (including communication with customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) as to the information contained herein). The opinions contained in this document may change, or differ from the opinions of employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC and SCB (Taiwan) will not provide any notice of any changes to or differences between the above-mentioned opinions. This document may cover companies with which SC or SCB (Taiwan) seeks to do business at times and issuers of financial instruments. Therefore, investors should understand that the information contained herein may serve as specific purposes as a result of conflict of interests of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC, SCB (Taiwan), the employees (including those who have discussions with the author) or customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have an interest in the products, related financial instruments or related derivative financial products contained herein; invest in those products at various prices and on different market conditions; have different or conflicting interests in those products. The potential impacts include market makers' related activities, such as dealing, investment, acting as agents, or performing financial or consulting services in relation to any of the products referred to in this document. **UAE:** DIFC - Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered Bank, Dubai International Financial Centre having its offices at Dubai International Financial Centre, Building 1, Gate Precinct, P.O. Box 999, Dubai, UAE is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority ("DFSA"). This document is intended for use only by Professional Clients and is not directed at Retail Clients as defined by the DFSA Rulebook. In the DIFC we are authorised to provide financial services only to clients who qualify as Professional Clients and Market Counterparties and not to Retail Clients. As a Professional Client you will not be given the higher retail client protection and compensation rights and if you use your right to be classified as a Retail Client we will be unable to provide financial services and products to you as we do not hold the required license to undertake such activities. For Islamic transactions, we are acting under the supervision of our Shariah Supervisory Committee. Relevant information on our Shariah Supervisory Committee is currently available on the Standard Chartered Bank website in the Islamic banking section. For residents of the UAE – Standard Chartered UAE ("SC UAE") is licensed by the Central Bank of the U.A.E. SC UAE is licensed by Securities and Commodities Authority to practice Promotion Activity. SC UAE does not provide financial analysis or consultation services in or into the UAE within the meaning of UAE Securities and Commodities Authority Decision No. 48/r of 2008 concerning financial consultation and financial analysis. **Uganda:** Our Investment products and services are distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Uganda Limited, which is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority as an investment adviser. **United Kingdom:** In the UK, Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. This communication has been approved by Standard Chartered Bank for the purposes of Section 21 (2) (b) of the United Kingdom's Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 ("FSMA") as amended in 2010 and 2012 only. Standard Chartered Bank (trading as Standard Chartered Private Bank) is also an authorised financial services provider (license number 45747) in terms of the South African Financial Advisory and Intermediary Services Act, 2002. The Materials have not been prepared in accordance with UK legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research, and that it is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research. **Vietnam:** This document is being distributed in Vietnam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited which is mainly regulated by State Bank of Vietnam (SBV). Recipients in Vietnam should contact Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited for any queries regarding any content of this document. **Zambia:** This document is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Zambia Plc, a company incorporated in Zambia and registered as a commercial bank and licensed by the Bank of Zambia under the Banking and Financial Services Act Chapter 387 of the Laws of Zambia.



standard
chartered

InvesTips

Redefining wealth through health and wellness

March 2026



WS Global CIO Office



The link between longevity, mental health and wealth outcomes has become clearer than ever before. Most investors focus solely on financial aspects, but studies suggest that a holistic approach, combining financial resilience, environmental harmony and physical/mental well-being, allows investors to build wealth that supports sustained, long-term success.

Steve Brice

Global Chief Investment Officer

This report explores the nuances of holistic, health- and wellness-centred wealth management and financial planning, including how these elements can be woven into wealth goals and the emerging trends shaping this approach.

Manpreet Gill

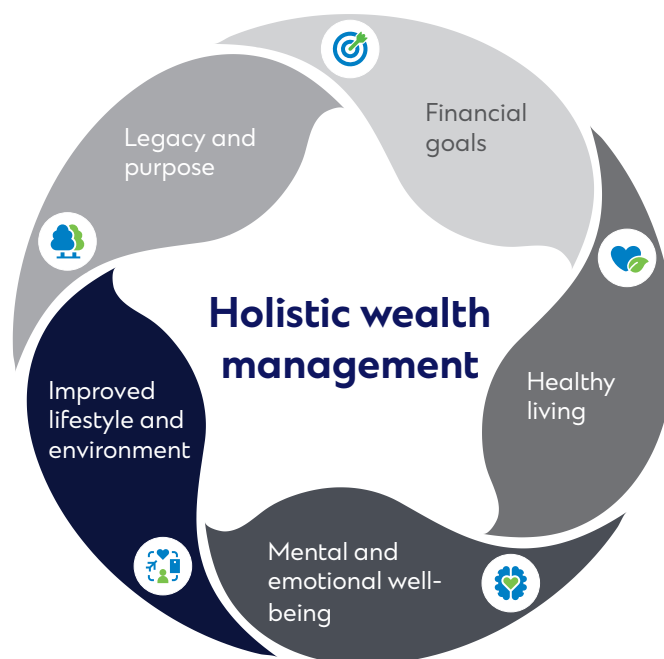
Chief Investment Officer, Africa,
Middle East & Europe (AMEE)

Understanding holistic wealth management

Holistic wealth management is more than just portfolio performance and asset growth. It focuses on an investor's overall well-being by integrating financial health with physical, mental and emotional wellness.

This integrated approach ensures your wealth journey will not only support your financial aspirations but will also ensure you lead a fulfilling, resilient and purpose-driven life. This approach incorporates:

- **Comprehensive healthcare cost planning**, including emergency funds, insurance, long-term care considerations and medical directives
- **Stress-aware financial planning** that accounts for emotional triggers and behavioural biases (guardrails) while incorporating a structured decision-making framework that supports bias-free investing and ensures adequate risk preparedness
- **Preventive health strategies** and longevity planning
- Access to wellness services and **wellness-centric living environments** to support healthier lifestyles
- Wealth decisions aligned with **personal lifestyle goals**, including eco-conscious living, cross-border investing and travel
- **Family harmony and communication frameworks** for estate planning and business succession

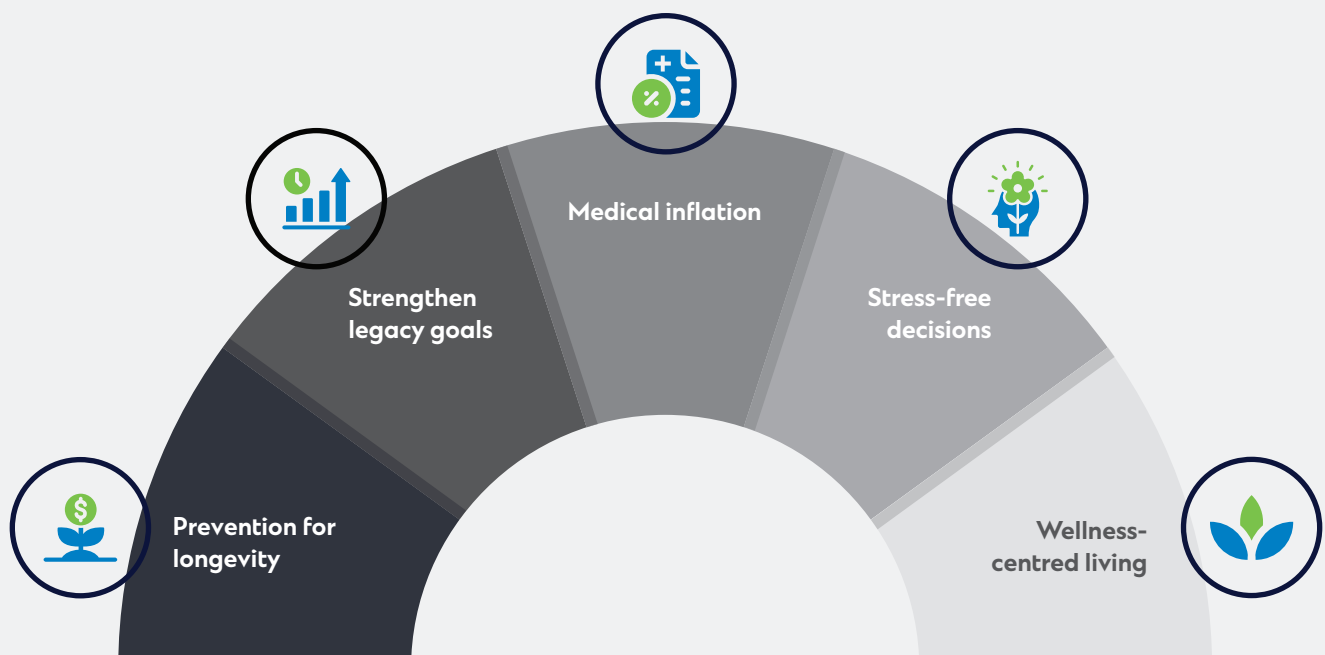


Source: Standard Chartered

Importance of health and wellness in wealth strategy

Wealth strategies that overlook health and well-being can often invite several challenges. For instance, an investor's long-term financial goals could be derailed if a sudden illness or unexpected medical emergency leads to a loss of income.

Why integrate health and wellness into financial decision-making?



Source: Standard Chartered

There are several strong reasons to include health and wellness as part of your broader wealth management strategy:

Healthcare costs are unpredictable, inflationary and rising

According to WTW's 2026 Global Medical Trends Survey Report, medical costs rose by 10.4% in 2025, continuing a double-digit trend. A majority of global insurers expect medical costs to trend higher over the next three years. Moreover, public healthcare systems are overwhelmed, necessitating investors to avail private insurance to lower out-of-pocket expenses. Unexpected medical events can erode your savings, weaken your long-term wealth strategy or trigger debt.

Mental and emotional health swings can influence financial decisions

Nearly 90% of our financial decisions are based on emotions. Studies further indicate that analytical capabilities get compromised when an individual is emotionally distressed or cognitively overwhelmed. This could trigger impulsive financial decisions, overreaction to market swings, panic selling, timing mistakes and overspending. Many investors experience intense performance pressure, owing to the responsibility of managing family wealth and burnout from work or business obligations, leading to cognitive overload and emotional distress.

Preventive health measures can influence longevity and health spans

Early screenings, vaccinations and proactive stress management shape longevity and health spans. An American College of Cardiology study found that individuals who followed healthy lifestyle and dietary habits had about a 90% lower risk of heart attacks and around a 75% lower risk of developing type-2 diabetes. Investors are turning to personalised biomarker panels and digital wellness gadgets/platforms as part of preventive health measures. In essence, preventive healthcare not only helps avoid disease but also protects 'human capital' and extends wealth accumulation years.



Strategies to integrate health planning into wealth management

Several studies have found that emotionally resilient individuals – often built thorough proactive stress management – engaged more in multi-generational financial discussions. The Milken Institute also noted that wealthy individuals who prioritised preventive healthcare not only had a better quality of life but also bolstered their wealth journey.

Investors who track their wellness metrics are more likely to stay invested in long-range financial plans. Here are some key strategies that investors can consider:

Health emergency buffers

Health emergency buffers act as a bridge between medical care and wealth by creating liquid capital that helps investors stay resilient during health shocks without compromising on long-term financial objectives. Preparedness for unforeseen medical events can prevent spirals of anxiety or forced portfolio liquidation. The need for sufficient healthcare emergency funds is also necessitated by the public healthcare systems being overwhelmed and exposing investors to such systems strain. In Asia, out-of-pocket spending remains elevated, and households shoulder around 40% of total health expenditure. A single medical emergency could disproportionately slow down wealth accumulation.

Insurance

A financial arrangement where you pay a premium to an insurer in exchange for protection against specific losses, is a common risk-transfer tool. Global premiums were valued over USD 7trn in 2024 across health, life and property and casualty (P&C) insurance. Different types of insurance cater to different risks and life goals:

Health insurance offers protection against any unforeseen medical shocks owing to illness or injury. It generally covers hospitalisation, medical expenses and ongoing treatment, helping individuals avoid out-of-pocket expenses. Health insurance is also a **wealth protection tool**, as it prevents financial shocks, ensures long-term earning capacity and allows disciplined financial planning.

- **International medical insurance** is ideal for globally mobile individuals and families. It provides seamless access to medical care across borders, often including hospitalisation, chronic condition management, emergency services and preventive care.
- **Integrated wellness insurance models** provide support across the entire health continuum – prevention, diagnosis, treatment, after-care and wellness coaching. They offer healthcare coordination, support long-term medical conditions and provide mental and emotional wellness support. These models also offer differentiated services such as priority access to specialists, second-medical-opinion services, personalised case management and high-touch medical concierge support that streamline health journeys and elevate outcomes.

- The health insurance landscape is undergoing a massive shift, with an emphasis on **holistic partnerships** driven by digital health trackers and wellness ecosystems. Many insurers partner with providers of healthtech devices and **wearables** to provide tailored health insights across the entire health lifecycle. In a sense, health insurance is transforming from a reimbursement product into an ongoing, tech-enabled wellness partner. This creates a win-win for both the insurer and insured, reducing premiums for the insured and lowering long-term claims for the insurance companies. Moreover, globally mobile individuals and families can benefit from priority access to global centres of medical excellence and cross-border care coordination.

Traditional health insurance vs integrated wellness insurance

Aspect	Traditional health insurance	Integrated wellness insurance
Approach	Reactive, claims driven	Proactive, continuous health management
Coverage	Hospitalisation, surgeries, recovery and eligible treatments	Medical cover, preventive care, mental health and after care services
Technology integration	Basic telehealth, limited wellness tools	Wearables, health analytics, telehealth and personalised coaching
Financial impact	Protects against high medical bills	Reduces long term healthcare costs, lowers claims and improves risk profile
Mental well-being support	Usually minimal or limited	Includes mental health and well-being support
Ideal for	Standard protection against health risks	Holistic health optimisation and long term well-being

Source: Standard Chartered

Life insurance hedges life risk. Beyond guaranteed payouts to beneficiaries upon the death of a policyholder, it provides emotional security and reduces anxiety because dependents are protected. Life insurance supports a person's wealth journey by **combining risk protection with disciplined, long-horizon savings**. Several modern-day policies integrate investment-linked solutions with protection to help investors accumulate wealth, while securing guaranteed benefits for their families. Life insurance solutions are also valuable tools in **estate planning**; they provide liquidity to cover for taxes and debt without the need to liquidate estate.

Property and casualty (P&C) insurance protects assets (property) and covers against liabilities (casualty), reducing anxiety and creating a 'peace-of-mind' effect. Although P&C insurance is often seen only as a basic protection tool, it is a critical health and wealth preservation technique. It **shields your assets, including houses and businesses**, from losses that can wipe out years of savings and derail long-term plans. With small, predictable premium payments, unpredictable, high-loss events can be hedged to support stable cash flow and long-term wealth preservation.

Insurance, in any form, reduces volatility and improves investors' financial resilience.

Preventive health strategies

Preventive health strategies can mitigate health risks while also reframing the approach to wealth. A McKinsey Health Institute paper found that investors who consider proactive wellness and health strategies tend to be more confident in financial/legacy planning:

- Advanced technologies such as predictive analytics, next-gen genomic sequencing and IoT-enabled wearables are leading the transformation **from a reactive to a proactive** approach towards healthcare. **Genomic testing** identifies health risks and predicts disease likelihood, guiding early diagnosis. **Wearables** deliver real-time data for continuous monitoring, early detection and personalised preventive care. These approaches can support precision medicine, better physical activity, cardiovascular health and diabetes management.
- Organisations are including **preventive programmes** as they can reduce healthcare costs and claims significantly. For example, Cleveland Clinic's employee wellness initiative saved its healthcare system approximately USD 180m by enabling employees to reach eight preventive health targets (including stress management, healthy BMI and annual primary-care visits). Savings free up more capital for long-term goals such as retirement and investments.
- Proactive health and wellness strategies help to protect the primary wealth engine, i.e., **human capital**. The Cleveland Clinic study also showed that healthy individuals could reduce their chronic-disease risk by nearly 90% through preventive strategies, thereby strengthening their long-term capacity to work. **Career longevity** could translate to higher earnings and preserve income streams.
- With reduced risk profiles owing to preventive care, investors generally pay lower premiums and premium increases are slower. A study indicated that individuals under preventive care programmes are able to reduce premiums roughly worth USD 1,600 per family. This **reduced cash outflow** helps households maintain steady investing habits.





Wellness-centred living

Wellness-centred living refers to homes, communities and neighbourhoods that are intentionally designed to support physical, mental and emotional well-being. **Clean air, natural light, low toxicity and noise, and an active lifestyle** are some key features of such health environments. The Global Wellness Institute (GWI) identifies wellness-centred communities as the next frontier of growth for the wellness industry. Wellness real estate has been growing at 19.5% annually, nearly 4x faster than traditional real estate.

GWI assessed clinical and building-environment data and found that improved health environments contributed to better health outcomes. Buyers are increasingly seeking **sustainable and health-forward environments**, a trend that supports premium willingness-to-pay for homes with superior air quality, natural light and biophilic design. Growing buyer preference, faster absorption and category outperformance indicate that wellness properties tend to hold value better and have better liquidity than traditional properties.

It's time for an integrated approach

All the available data points to the fact that investors are increasingly recognising health and wellness as key components of holistic wealth management. This has resulted in systemic shifts in the financial planning and investing landscape. Homes with clear air, natural light, low toxicity and green access are being pursued for their potential to contribute to overall wellness and financial stability. Insurance is seeing an evident shift from being a claims-driven coverage to offering preventive care, mental and emotional support, telemedicine access and health analytics, which enables tailored advice and risk management. Wearables and real time health data are helping improve investors' overall well-being and financial behaviour.

As the link between wealth and health strengthens, investors who follow a holistic and integrated approach are likely to build the most resilient portfolios.



Disclosure

This document is confidential and may also be privileged. If you are not the intended recipient, please destroy all copies and notify the sender immediately. This document is being distributed for general information only and is subject to the relevant disclaimers available at our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures. It is not and does not constitute research material, independent research, an offer, recommendation or solicitation to enter into any transaction or adopt any hedging, trading or investment strategy, in relation to any securities or other financial instruments. This document is for general evaluation only. It does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs of any particular person or class of persons and it has not been prepared for any particular person or class of persons. You should not rely on any contents of this document in making any investment decisions. Before making any investment, you should carefully read the relevant offering documents and seek independent legal, tax and regulatory advice. In particular, we recommend you to seek advice regarding the suitability of the investment product, taking into account your specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs, before you make a commitment to purchase the investment product. Opinions, projections and estimates are solely those of SC at the date of this document and subject to change without notice. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. The value of investments, and the income from them, can go down as well as up, and you may not recover the amount of your original investment. You are not certain to make a profit and may lose money. Any forecast contained herein as to likely future movements in rates or prices or likely future events or occurrences constitutes an opinion only and is not indicative of actual future movements in rates or prices or actual future events or occurrences (as the case may be). This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of the Standard Chartered Group (as defined below). Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered PLC, the ultimate parent company of Standard Chartered Bank, together with its subsidiaries and affiliates (including each branch or representative office), form the Standard Chartered Group. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of Standard Chartered. Private banking activities may be carried out internationally by different legal entities and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group (each an "SC Group Entity") according to local regulatory requirements. Not all products and services are provided by all branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group. Some of the SC Group Entities only act as representatives of Standard Chartered Private Bank and may not be able to offer products and services or offer advice to clients.

Copyright © 2026, Accounting Research & Analytics, LLC d/b/a CFRA (and its affiliates, as applicable). Reproduction of content provided by CFRA in any form is prohibited except with the prior written permission of CFRA. CFRA content is not investment advice and a reference to or observation concerning a security or investment provided in the CFRA SERVICES is not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold such investment or security or make any other investment decisions. The CFRA content contains opinions of CFRA based upon publicly-available information that CFRA believes to be reliable and the opinions are subject to change without notice. This analysis has not been submitted to, nor received approval from, the United States Securities and Exchange Commission or any other regulatory body. While CFRA exercised due care in compiling this analysis, CFRA, ITS THIRD-PARTY SUPPLIERS, AND ALL RELATED ENTITIES SPECIFICALLY DISCLAIM ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, ANY WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE OR USE, to the full extent permitted by law, regarding the accuracy, completeness, or usefulness of this information and assumes no liability with respect to the consequences of relying on this information for investment or other purposes. No content provided by CFRA (including ratings, credit-related analyses and data, valuations, model, software or other application or output therefrom) or any part thereof may be modified, reverse engineered, reproduced or distributed in any form by any means, or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of CFRA, and such content shall not be used for any unlawful or unauthorized purposes. CFRA and any third-party providers, as well as their directors, officers, shareholders, employees or agents do not guarantee the accuracy, completeness, timeliness or availability of such content. In no event shall CFRA, its affiliates, or their third-party suppliers be liable for any direct, indirect, special, or consequential damages, costs, expenses, legal fees, or losses (including lost income or lost profit and opportunity costs) in connection with a subscriber's, subscriber's customer's, or other's use of CFRA's content.

Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) Disclaimer

Banking activities may be carried out internationally by different branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group according to local regulatory requirements. Opinions may contain outright "buy", "sell", "hold" or other opinions. The time horizon of this opinion is dependent on prevailing market conditions and there is no planned frequency for updates to the opinion. This opinion is not independent of Standard Chartered Group's trading strategies or positions. Standard Chartered Group and/or its affiliates or its respective officers, directors, employee benefit programmes or employees, including persons involved in the preparation or issuance of this document may at any time, to the extent permitted by applicable law and/or regulation, be long or short any securities or financial instruments referred to in this document or have material interest in any such securities or related investments. Therefore, it is possible, and you should assume, that Standard Chartered Group has a material interest in one or more of the financial instruments mentioned

herein. Please refer to our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures for more detailed disclosures, including past opinions/ recommendations in the last 12 months and conflict of interests, as well as disclaimers. A covering strategist may have a financial interest in the debt or equity securities of this company/issuer. All covering strategist are licensed to provide investment recommendations under Monetary Authority of Singapore or Hong Kong Monetary Authority. This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of Standard Chartered Group.

Sustainable Investments

Any ESG data used or referred to has been provided by Morningstar, Sustainalytics, MSCI or Bloomberg. Refer to 1) Morningstar website under Sustainable Investing, 2) Sustainalytics website under ESG Risk Ratings, 3) MSCI website under ESG Business Involvement Screening Research and 4) Bloomberg green, social & sustainability bonds guide for more information. The ESG data is as at the date of publication based on data provided, is for informational purpose only and is not warranted to be complete, timely, accurate or suitable for a particular purpose, and it may be subject to change. Sustainable Investments (SI): This refers to funds that have been classified as 'ESG Intentional Investments – Overall' by Morningstar. SI funds have explicitly stated in their prospectus and regulatory filings that they either incorporate ESG factors into the investment process or have a thematic focus on the environment, gender diversity, low carbon, renewable energy, water or community development. For equity, it refers to shares/stocks issued by companies with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible. For bonds, it refers to debt instruments issued by issuers with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible, and/or those being certified green, social, sustainable bonds by Bloomberg. For structured products, it refers to products that are issued by any issuer who has a Sustainable Finance framework that aligns with Standard Chartered's Green and Sustainable Product Framework, with underlying assets that are part of the Sustainable Investment universe or separately approved by Standard Chartered's Sustainable Finance Governance Committee. Sustainalytics ESG risk ratings shown are factual and are not an indicator that the product is classified or marketed as "green", "sustainable" or similar under any particular classification system or framework.

Country/Market Specific Disclosures

Bahrain: This document is being distributed in Bahrain by Standard Chartered Bank, Bahrain Branch, having its address at P.O. 29, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain, is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed by the Central Bank of Bahrain as a conventional retail bank. **Botswana:** This document is being distributed in Botswana by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank Botswana Limited which is a financial institution licensed under the Section 6 of the Banking Act CAP 46:04 and is listed in the Botswana Stock Exchange. **Brunei Darussalam:** This document is being distributed in Brunei Darussalam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Brunei Branch) | Registration Number RFC/61 and Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd | Registration Number RC20001003. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd is a limited liability company registered with the Registry of Companies with Registration Number RC20001003 and licensed by Brunei Darussalam Central Bank as a Capital Markets Service License Holder with License Number BDCB/R/CMU/S3-CL and it is authorised to conduct Islamic investment business through an Islamic window. **China Mainland:** This document is being distributed in China by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (China) Limited which is mainly regulated by National Financial Regulatory Administration (NFRA), State Administration of Foreign Exchange (SAFE), and People's Bank of China (PBOC). **Hong Kong:** In Hong Kong, this document, except for any portion advising on or facilitating any decision on futures contracts trading, is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("SCBHK"), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. SCBHK has its registered address at 32/F, Standard Chartered Bank Building, 4-4A Des Voeux Road Central, Hong Kong and is regulated by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority and registered with the Securities and Futures Commission ("SFC") to carry on Type 1 (dealing in securities), Type 4 (advising on securities), Type 6 (advising on corporate finance) and Type 9 (asset management) regulated activity under the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571) ("SFO") (CE No. AJ1614). The contents of this document have not been reviewed by any regulatory authority in Hong Kong and you are advised to exercise caution in relation to any offer set out herein. If you are in doubt about any of the contents of this document, you should obtain independent professional advice. Any product named herein may not be offered or sold in Hong Kong by means of any document at any time other than to "professional investors" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance. In addition, this document may not be issued or possessed for the purposes of issue, whether in Hong Kong or elsewhere, and any interests may not be disposed of, to any person unless such person is outside Hong Kong or is a "professional investor" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance, or as otherwise may be permitted by that ordinance. In Hong Kong, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBHK, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. **Ghana:** Standard Chartered Bank Ghana Limited accepts no liability and will not be liable for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to feedback.ghana@sc.com. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 0302610750 for any questions or service queries. You are advised not to send any confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail, as Standard Chartered makes no representations or warranties as

to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. Standard Chartered shall not be responsible for any loss or damage suffered by you arising from your decision to use e-mail to communicate with the Bank. **India:** This document is being distributed in India by Standard Chartered in its capacity as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of any other third party financial products. Standard Chartered does not offer any 'Investment Advice' as defined in the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013 or otherwise. Services/products related securities business offered by Standard Chartered are not intended for any person, who is a resident of any jurisdiction, the laws of which imposes prohibition on soliciting the securities business in that jurisdiction without going through the registration requirements and/or prohibit the use of any information contained in this document. **Indonesia:** This document is being distributed in Indonesia by Standard Chartered Bank, Indonesia branch, which is a financial institution licensed and supervised by Otoritas Jasa Keuangan (Financial Service Authority) and Bank Indonesia. **Jersey:** In Jersey, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the Registered Business Name of the Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is regulated by the Jersey Financial Services Commission. Copies of the latest audited accounts of Standard Chartered Bank are available from its principal place of business in Jersey: PO Box 80, 15 Castle Street, St Helier, Jersey JE4 8PT. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter in 1853 Reference Number ZC 18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is also an authorised financial services provider under license number 44946 issued by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority of the Republic of South Africa. Jersey is not part of the United Kingdom and all business transacted with Standard Chartered Bank, Jersey Branch and other SC Group Entity outside of the United Kingdom, are not subject to some or any of the investor protection and compensation schemes available under United Kingdom law. **Kenya:** This document is being distributed in Kenya by and is attributable to Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited. Investment Products and Services are distributed by Standard Chartered Investment Services Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited that is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority in Kenya, as a Fund Manager. Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited is regulated by the Central Bank of Kenya. **Malaysia:** This document is being distributed in Malaysia by Standard Chartered Bank Malaysia Berhad ("SCBMB"). Recipients in Malaysia should contact SCBMB in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. This document has not been reviewed by the Securities Commission Malaysia. The product lodgement, registration, submission or approval by the Securities Commission of Malaysia does not amount to nor indicate recommendation or endorsement of the product, service or promotional activity. Investment products are not deposits and are not obligations of, not guaranteed by, and not protected by SCBMB or any of the affiliates or subsidiaries, or by Perbadanan Insurans Deposit Malaysia, any government or insurance agency. Investment products are subject to investment risks, including the possible loss of the principal amount invested. SCBMB expressly disclaim any liability and responsibility for any loss arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) arising from the financial losses of the Investment Products due to market condition. **Nigeria:** This document is being distributed in Nigeria by Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited (SCB Nigeria), a bank duly licensed and regulated by the Central Bank of Nigeria. SCB Nigeria accepts no liability for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to clientcare.ng@sc.com requesting to be removed from our mailing list. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 02 012772514 for any questions or service queries. SCB Nigeria shall not be responsible for any loss or damage arising from your decision to send confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail. SCB Nigeria makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. **Pakistan:** This document is being distributed in Pakistan by, and attributable to Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited having its registered office at PO Box 5556, I.I Chundrigar Road Karachi, which is a banking company registered with State Bank of Pakistan under Banking Companies Ordinance 1962 and is also having licensed issued by Securities & Exchange Commission of Pakistan for Security Advisors. Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited acts as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of other third-party financial products. **Singapore:** This document is being distributed in Singapore by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited (Registration No. 201224747C/ GST Group Registration No. MR-8500053-0, "SCBSL"). Recipients in Singapore should contact SCBSL in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. SCBSL is an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed to conduct banking business in Singapore under the Singapore Banking Act, 1970. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBSL. IN RELATION TO ANY SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT REFERRED TO IN THIS DOCUMENT, THIS DOCUMENT, TOGETHER WITH THE ISSUER DOCUMENTATION, SHALL BE DEEMED AN INFORMATION MEMORANDUM (AS DEFINED IN SECTION 275 OF THE SECURITIES AND FUTURES ACT, 2001 ("SFA")). THIS DOCUMENT IS INTENDED FOR DISTRIBUTION TO ACCREDITED INVESTORS, AS DEFINED IN SECTION 4A(1)(a) OF THE SFA, OR ON THE BASIS THAT THE SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT MAY ONLY BE ACQUIRED AT A CONSIDERATION OF NOT LESS THAN S\$200,000 (OR ITS EQUIVALENT IN A FOREIGN CURRENCY) FOR EACH TRANSACTION. Further, in relation to any security or securities-based derivatives contract, neither this document nor the Issuer Documentation has been registered as a prospectus with the Monetary Authority of Singapore under the SFA. Accordingly, this document and any other document or material in connection with the offer or sale, or invitation for subscription or purchase, of the product may not be circulated or distributed,

nor may the product be offered or sold, or be made the subject of an invitation for subscription or purchase, whether directly or indirectly, to persons other than a relevant person pursuant to section 275(1) of the SFA, or any person pursuant to section 275(1A) of the SFA, and in accordance with the conditions specified in section 275 of the SFA, or pursuant to, and in accordance with the conditions of, any other applicable provision of the SFA. In relation to any collective investment schemes referred to in this document, this document is for general information purposes only and is not an offering document or prospectus (as defined in the SFA). This document is not, nor is it intended to be (i) an offer or solicitation of an offer to buy or sell any capital markets product; or (ii) an advertisement of an offer or intended offer of any capital markets product.

Deposit Insurance Scheme: Singapore dollar deposits of non-bank depositors are insured by the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation, for up to S\$100,000 in aggregate per depositor per Scheme member by law. Foreign currency deposits, dual currency investments, structured deposits and other investment products are not insured. This advertisement has not been reviewed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Taiwan: SC Group Entity or Standard Chartered Bank (Taiwan) Limited ("SCB (Taiwan)") may be involved in the financial instruments contained herein or other related financial instruments. The author of this document may have discussed the information contained herein with other employees or agents of SC or SCB (Taiwan). The author and the above-mentioned employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have taken related actions in respect of the information involved (including communication with customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) as to the information contained herein). The opinions contained in this document may change, or differ from the opinions of employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC and SCB (Taiwan) will not provide any notice of any changes to or differences between the above-mentioned opinions. This document may cover companies with which SC or SCB (Taiwan) seeks to do business at times and issuers of financial instruments. Therefore, investors should understand that the information contained herein may serve as specific purposes as a result of conflict of interests of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC, SCB (Taiwan), the employees (including those who have discussions with the author) or customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have an interest in the products, related financial instruments or related derivative financial products contained herein; invest in those products at various prices and on different market conditions; have different or conflicting interests in those products. The potential impacts include market makers' related activities, such as dealing, investment, acting as agents, or performing financial or consulting services in relation to any of the products referred to in this document.

UAE: DIFC – Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered Bank, Dubai International Financial Centre having its offices at Dubai International Financial Centre, Building 1, Gate Precinct, P.O. Box 999, Dubai, UAE is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority ("DFSA"). This document is intended for use only by Professional Clients and is not directed at Retail Clients as defined by the DFSA Rulebook. In the DIFC we are authorised to provide financial services only to clients who qualify as Professional Clients and Market Counterparties and not to Retail Clients. As a Professional Client you will not be given the higher retail client protection and compensation rights and if you use your right to be classified as a Retail Client we will be unable to provide financial services and products to you as we do not hold the required license to undertake such activities. For Islamic transactions, we are acting under the supervision of our Shariah Supervisory Committee. Relevant information on our Shariah Supervisory Committee is currently available on the Standard Chartered Bank website in the Islamic banking section. For residents of the UAE – Standard Chartered UAE ("SC UAE") is licensed by the Central Bank of the U.A.E. SC UAE is licensed by Securities and Commodities Authority to practice Promotion Activity. SC UAE does not provide financial analysis or consultation services in or into the UAE within the meaning of UAE Securities and Commodities Authority Decision No. 48/r of 2008 concerning financial consultation and financial analysis.

Uganda: Our Investment products and services are distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Uganda Limited, which is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority as an investment adviser.

United Kingdom: In the UK, Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. This communication has been approved by Standard Chartered Bank for the purposes of Section 21 (2) (b) of the United Kingdom's Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 ("FSMA") as amended in 2010 and 2012 only. Standard Chartered Bank (trading as Standard Chartered Private Bank) is also an authorised financial services provider (license number 45747) in terms of the South African Financial Advisory and Intermediary Services Act, 2002. The Materials have not been prepared in accordance with UK legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research, and that it is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Vietnam: This document is being distributed in Vietnam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited which is mainly regulated by State Bank of Vietnam (SBV). Recipients in Vietnam should contact Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited for any queries regarding any content of this document.

Zambia: This document is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Zambia Plc, a company incorporated in Zambia and registered as a commercial bank and licensed by the Bank of Zambia under the Banking and Financial Services Act Chapter 387 of the Laws of Zambia.



standard
chartered
global private bank

InvesTips

Redefining wealth through health and wellness

March 2026



WS Global CIO Office



The link between longevity, mental health and wealth outcomes has become clearer than ever before. Most investors focus solely on financial aspects, but studies suggest that a holistic approach, combining financial resilience, environmental harmony and physical/mental well-being, allows investors to build wealth that supports sustained, long-term success.

Steve Brice

Global Chief Investment Officer

This report explores the nuances of holistic, health- and wellness-centred wealth management and financial planning, including how these elements can be woven into wealth goals and the emerging trends shaping this approach.

Manpreet Gill

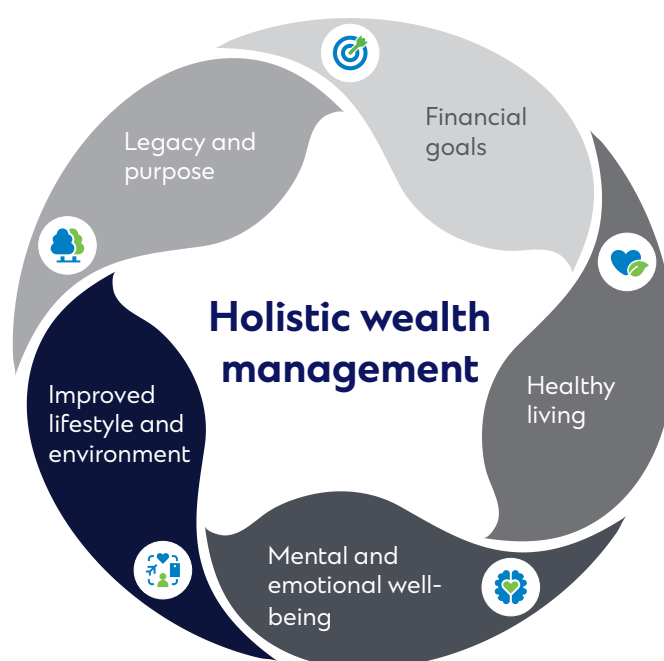
Chief Investment Officer, Africa, Middle East & Europe (AMEE)

Understanding holistic wealth management

Holistic wealth management is more than just portfolio performance and asset growth. It focuses on an investor's overall well-being by integrating financial health with physical, mental and emotional wellness.

This integrated approach ensures your wealth journey will not only support your financial aspirations but will also ensure you lead a fulfilling, resilient and purpose-driven life. This approach incorporates:

- **Comprehensive healthcare cost planning**, including emergency funds, insurance, long-term care considerations and medical directives
- **Stress-aware financial planning** that accounts for emotional triggers and behavioural biases (guardrails) while incorporating a structured decision-making framework that supports bias-free investing and ensures adequate risk preparedness
- **Preventive health strategies** and longevity planning
- Access to wellness services and **wellness-centric living environments** to support healthier lifestyles
- Wealth decisions aligned with **personal lifestyle goals**, including eco-conscious living, cross-border investing and travel
- **Family harmony and communication frameworks** for estate planning and business succession

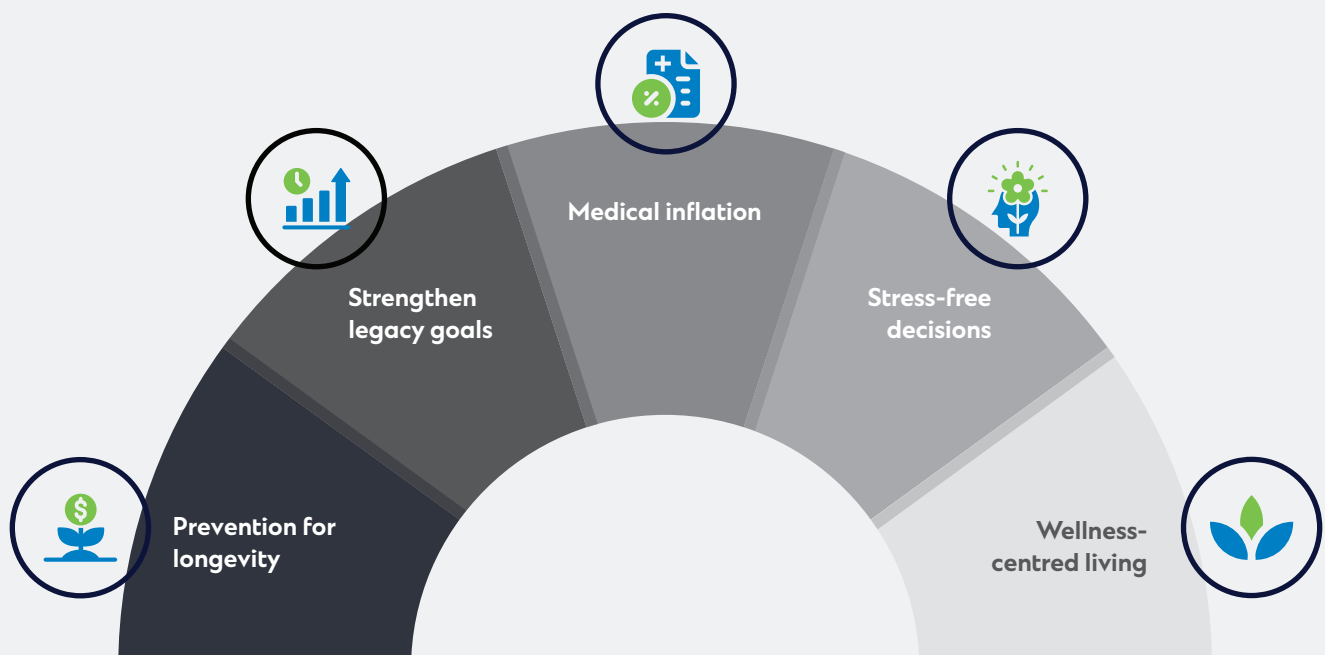


Source: Standard Chartered

Importance of health and wellness in wealth strategy

Wealth strategies that overlook health and well-being can often invite several challenges. For instance, an investor's long-term financial goals could be derailed if a sudden illness or unexpected medical emergency leads to a loss of income.

Why integrate health and wellness into financial decision-making?



Source: Standard Chartered

There are several strong reasons to include health and wellness as part of your broader wealth management strategy:

Healthcare costs are unpredictable, inflationary and rising

According to WTW's 2026 Global Medical Trends Survey Report, medical costs rose by 10.4% in 2025, continuing a double-digit trend. A majority of global insurers expect medical costs to trend higher over the next three years. Moreover, public healthcare systems are overwhelmed, necessitating investors to avail private insurance to lower out-of-pocket expenses. Unexpected medical events can erode your savings, weaken your long-term wealth strategy or trigger debt.

Mental and emotional health swings can influence financial decisions

Nearly 90% of our financial decisions are based on emotions. Studies further indicate that analytical capabilities get compromised when an individual is emotionally distressed or cognitively overwhelmed. This could trigger impulsive financial decisions, overreaction to market swings, panic selling, timing mistakes and overspending. Many investors experience intense performance pressure, owing to the responsibility of managing family wealth and burnout from work or business obligations, leading to cognitive overload and emotional distress.

Preventive health measures can influence longevity and health spans

Early screenings, vaccinations and proactive stress management shape longevity and health spans. An American College of Cardiology study found that individuals who followed healthy lifestyle and dietary habits had about a 90% lower risk of heart attacks and around a 75% lower risk of developing type-2 diabetes. Investors are turning to personalised biomarker panels and digital wellness gadgets/platforms as part of preventive health measures. In essence, preventive healthcare not only helps avoid disease but also protects 'human capital' and extends wealth accumulation years.



Strategies to integrate health planning into wealth management

Several studies have found that emotionally resilient individuals – often built thorough proactive stress management – engaged more in multi-generational financial discussions. The Milken Institute also noted that wealthy individuals who prioritised preventive healthcare not only had a better quality of life but also bolstered their wealth journey.

Investors who track their wellness metrics are more likely to stay invested in long-range financial plans. Here are some key strategies that investors can consider:

Health emergency buffers

Health emergency buffers act as a bridge between medical care and wealth by creating liquid capital that helps investors stay resilient during health shocks without compromising on long-term financial objectives. Preparedness for unforeseen medical events can prevent spirals of anxiety or forced portfolio liquidation. The need for sufficient healthcare emergency funds is also necessitated by the public healthcare systems being overwhelmed and exposing investors to such systems strain. In Asia, out-of-pocket spending remains elevated, and households shoulder around 40% of total health expenditure. A single medical emergency could disproportionately slow down wealth accumulation.

Insurance

A financial arrangement where you pay a premium to an insurer in exchange for protection against specific losses, is a common risk-transfer tool. Global premiums were valued over USD 7trn in 2024 across health, life and property and casualty (P&C) insurance. Different types of insurance cater to different risks and life goals:

Health insurance offers protection against any unforeseen medical shocks owing to illness or injury. It generally covers hospitalisation, medical expenses and ongoing treatment, helping individuals avoid out-of-pocket expenses. Health insurance is also a **wealth protection tool**, as it prevents financial shocks, ensures long-term earning capacity and allows disciplined financial planning.

- **International medical insurance** is ideal for globally mobile individuals and families. It provides seamless access to medical care across borders, often including hospitalisation, chronic condition management, emergency services and preventive care.
- **Integrated wellness insurance models** provide support across the entire health continuum – prevention, diagnosis, treatment, after-care and wellness coaching. They offer healthcare coordination, support long-term medical conditions and provide mental and emotional wellness support. These models also offer differentiated services such as priority access to specialists, second-medical-opinion services, personalised case management and high-touch medical concierge support that streamline health journeys and elevate outcomes.

- The health insurance landscape is undergoing a massive shift, with an emphasis on **holistic partnerships** driven by digital health trackers and wellness ecosystems. Many insurers partner with providers of healthtech devices and **wearables** to provide tailored health insights across the entire health lifecycle. In a sense, health insurance is transforming from a reimbursement product into an ongoing, tech-enabled wellness partner. This creates a win-win for both the insurer and insured, reducing premiums for the insured and lowering long-term claims for the insurance companies. Moreover, globally mobile individuals and families can benefit from priority access to global centres of medical excellence and cross-border care coordination.

Traditional health insurance vs integrated wellness insurance

Aspect	Traditional health insurance	Integrated wellness insurance
Approach	Reactive, claims driven	Proactive, continuous health management
Coverage	Hospitalisation, surgeries, recovery and eligible treatments	Medical cover, preventive care, mental health and after care services
Technology integration	Basic telehealth, limited wellness tools	Wearables, health analytics, telehealth and personalised coaching
Financial impact	Protects against high medical bills	Reduces long term healthcare costs, lowers claims and improves risk profile
Mental well-being support	Usually minimal or limited	Includes mental health and well-being support
Ideal for	Standard protection against health risks	Holistic health optimisation and long term well-being

Source: Standard Chartered

Life insurance hedges life risk. Beyond guaranteed payouts to beneficiaries upon the death of a policyholder, it provides emotional security and reduces anxiety because dependents are protected. Life insurance supports a person's wealth journey by **combining risk protection with disciplined, long-horizon savings**. Several modern-day policies integrate investment-linked solutions with protection to help investors accumulate wealth, while securing guaranteed benefits for their families. Life insurance solutions are also valuable tools in **estate planning**; they provide liquidity to cover for taxes and debt without the need to liquidate estate.

Property and casualty (P&C) insurance protects assets (property) and covers against liabilities (casualty), reducing anxiety and creating a 'peace-of-mind' effect. Although P&C insurance is often seen only as a basic protection tool, it is a critical health and wealth preservation technique. It **shields your assets, including houses and businesses**, from losses that can wipe out years of savings and derail long-term plans. With small, predictable premium payments, unpredictable, high-loss events can be hedged to support stable cash flow and long-term wealth preservation.

Insurance, in any form, reduces volatility and improves investors' financial resilience.

Preventive health strategies

Preventive health strategies can mitigate health risks while also reframing the approach to wealth. A McKinsey Health Institute paper found that investors who consider proactive wellness and health strategies tend to be more confident in financial/legacy planning:

- Advanced technologies such as predictive analytics, next-gen genomic sequencing and IoT-enabled wearables are leading the transformation **from a reactive to a proactive** approach towards healthcare. **Genomic testing** identifies health risks and predicts disease likelihood, guiding early diagnosis. **Wearables** deliver real-time data for continuous monitoring, early detection and personalised preventive care. These approaches can support precision medicine, better physical activity, cardiovascular health and diabetes management.
- Organisations are including **preventive programmes** as they can reduce healthcare costs and claims significantly. For example, Cleveland Clinic's employee wellness initiative saved its healthcare system approximately USD 180m by enabling employees to reach eight preventive health targets (including stress management, healthy BMI and annual primary-care visits). Savings free up more capital for long-term goals such as retirement and investments.
- Proactive health and wellness strategies help to protect the primary wealth engine, i.e., **human capital**. The Cleveland Clinic study also showed that healthy individuals could reduce their chronic-disease risk by nearly 90% through preventive strategies, thereby strengthening their long-term capacity to work. **Career longevity** could translate to higher earnings and preserve income streams.
- With reduced risk profiles owing to preventive care, investors generally pay lower premiums and premium increases are slower. A study indicated that individuals under preventive care programmes are able to reduce premiums roughly worth USD 1,600 per family. This **reduced cash outflow** helps households maintain steady investing habits.





Wellness-centred living

Wellness-centred living refers to homes, communities and neighbourhoods that are intentionally designed to support physical, mental and emotional well-being. **Clean air, natural light, low toxicity and noise, and an active lifestyle** are some key features of such health environments. The Global Wellness Institute (GWI) identifies wellness-centred communities as the next frontier of growth for the wellness industry. Wellness real estate has been growing at 19.5% annually, nearly 4x faster than traditional real estate.

GWI assessed clinical and building-environment data and found that improved health environments contributed to better health outcomes. Buyers are increasingly seeking **sustainable and health-forward environments**, a trend that supports premium willingness-to-pay for homes with superior air quality, natural light and biophilic design. Growing buyer preference, faster absorption and category outperformance indicate that wellness properties tend to hold value better and have better liquidity than traditional properties.

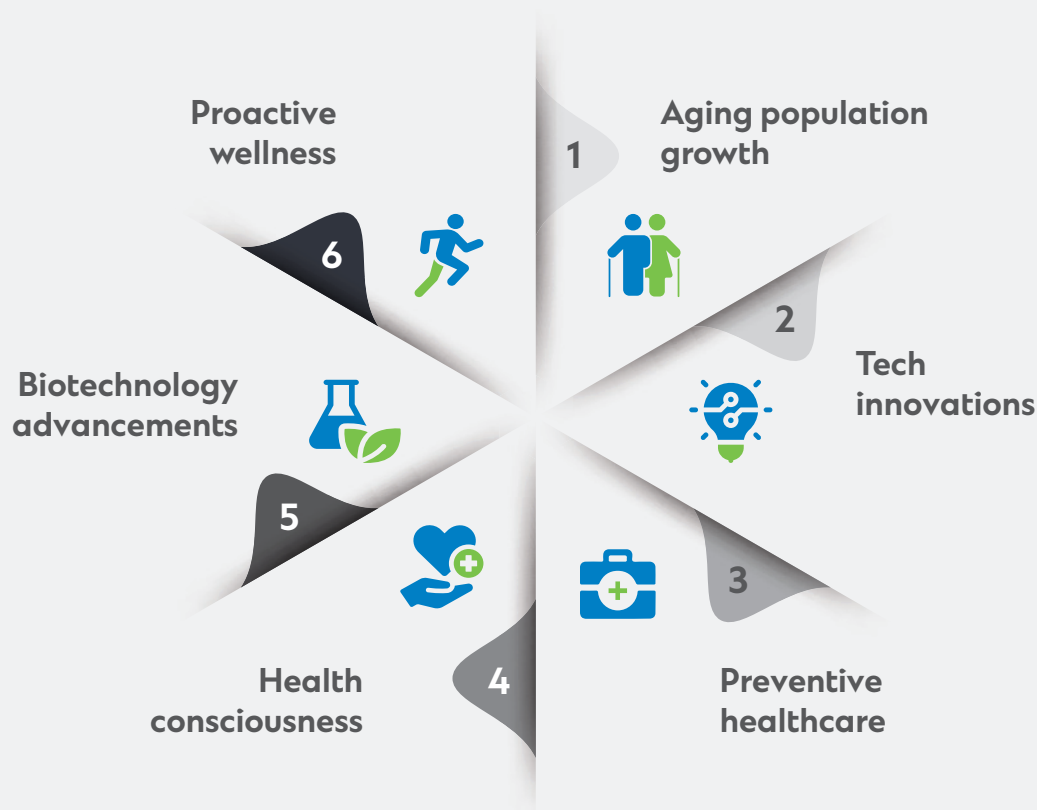
The rise of longevity economy

Longevity economy refers to the economic value generated by individuals aged 50 and above – a segment that is increasingly becoming a major contributor to GDP, employment and income across 76 economies. By 2050, senior citizens may account for nearly 26% of the world's population, underscoring the scale of this shift.

Employment, entrepreneurship, investments and consumption patterns are largely shaped by longer life expectancy. There is a growing need and opportunity to rejig wealth portfolios to align them with longer lives and health spans. Investing in wellness and healthcare becomes critical for investors who want to remain productive and continue accumulating wealth well into their later years.

In short, the longevity economy is about the economic power of longer, healthier and more productive lives that continue to accumulate and preserve wealth.

Key drivers of the longevity economy



Source: Standard Chartered

Investment opportunities

As longer health spans shift focus to preventive care and digital wellness, investments aligned with this new reality can add significant value to investor portfolios and make them more resilient.



Some prominent investment options for sophisticated investors include:

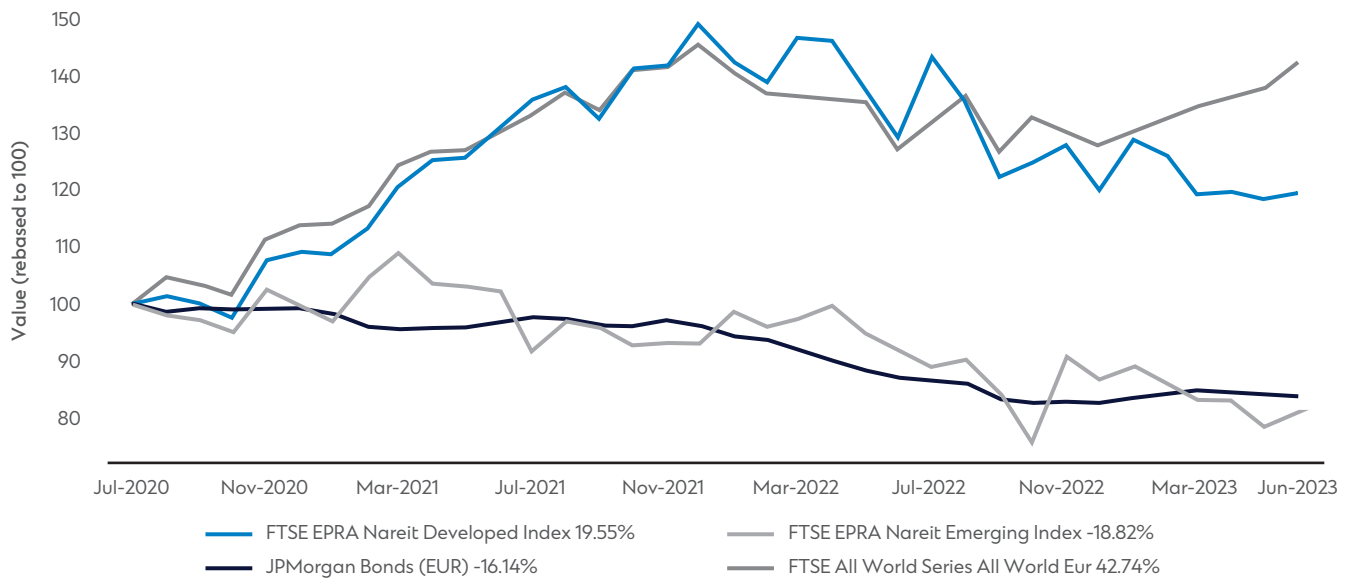
Healthcare real estate investment trusts (REITs)

Healthcare real estate investment trusts (REITs) own, lease or finance health-anchored properties such as medical centres, hospitals and wellness-aligned facilities. The income is typically in the form of inflation-adjusted lease/rental income or interest payments on the loans extended. These assets sit at the core of the fast-growing wellness real estate market. As life and health spans increase, demand for rehabilitative care, medical services and wellness-centred properties rises. Investing in healthcare REITs can capture this need-based, non-cyclical demand, offering a wide range of benefits to complex portfolios, such as:

- **Inflation-adjusted, stable income streams from rentals/leases:** The demand often remains steady across economic cycles, and the contractual agreements for properties are typically long term, offering investors clear visibility into cash flow. Dividend payouts from REITs (often mandatory) offer regular cashflows for investors, enhancing liquidity and income stability considerably in complex portfolios.

- **Healthcare REITs bear low correlation with traditional assets:** This asset class provides meaningful diversification to a portfolio. Real estate, in general, moves differently in magnitude, timing and trend compared to traditional portfolios. Healthcare REITs often respond more slowly to changing undercurrents than equities and bonds.

Global real estate vs equities and bonds – Total returns (EUR) rolling 36 months performance



Source: Standard Chartered, EPRA

- **Downside protection:** Healthcare REITs derive revenue from hospitals, senior housing and medical offices – essential services that tend to deliver a defensive performance during economic downturns.



Thematic investing and early-stage funding

Thematic investing and early-stage funding in the health and wellness space can also be promising additions to complex portfolios:

- **Senior living platforms/spaces, assisted-living development financing, longevity biotech, rehabilitation technology, mobility devices and remote monitoring** look promising in this space. Publicly listed opportunities are currently limited, but sophisticated investors can consider using the private equity route to explore opportunities in this space.
- Governments are shifting spend towards preventive healthcare, diagnostics and early detection. This suggests **sustained growth of at-home diagnostics platforms, precision screening and preventive care clinics**. Early-stage funding opportunities in metabolic health and healthy ageing innovations can be considered.
- Rising awareness around mental/emotional health is expected to pave the way for **behavioural health platforms, tele-therapy solutions, sleep tech and neurotech** investment options. This segment is in its nascent stages, which may present early-stage funding opportunities.

Venture philanthropy

Venture philanthropy in the health and well-being space can also be explored. It combines venture capital (VC) principles with philanthropy for social good. The healthy ageing funding gap (the mismatch between low funding and increased demand for ageing-related services, such as senior care and community wellness infrastructure) de-risks the venture philanthropy route. The affordable and community wellness segment remains underfunded despite enormous demand. Similarly, non-commercial capital is essential to support health-conscious environments in low-income and rural communities. Several ventures in this space tend to have low initial financial returns but high social returns, making them viable targets for venture philanthropy.



Health and wellness in legacy planning

A health and wellness-aligned legacy plan protects and ensures a seamless wealth transition while nurturing a culture of wellness stewardship for future generations. Let's look at some key strategies that can help draft a comprehensive legacy plan:



- **Long-term care directives (LTCDs)** traditionally focused on end-of-life care and power of attorney when the principal (the person who creates the directive) becomes incapacitated. Modern-day directives are attuned to **extended life rather than end-of-life care**. Today, a comprehensive LTCD would include:
 - Lifestyle-appropriate care for healthy ageing and not only terminal care. Active ageing needs, such as mobility assistance, precision nutrition, longevity coaching and therapy, are now laid out in LTCDs.
 - Directives on preventive care, early intervention and health optimisation (e.g., regular biomarker screening, precision health programmes and wearables) are documented to ensure proactive, personalised health stewardship aligned with the individual's evolving goals and values.
 - Mental and emotional well-being are seen as critical aspects for improved quality of life; LTCDs now include mental well-being guidelines, such as therapy access, social-connection preferences, sleep and neuro therapies.



- As **digital health integration and wearables** grow more prevalent, sophisticated investors face the increasing risk of **data leaks** that could harm their reputation. Explicit provisions around data rights, storage and sharing to ensure robust cyber protection over time are now actively pursued in legacy planning. Trusted advocate roles may need to be established that allow family members to easily access and share their health records with providers while ensuring confidentiality.



- **Family governance frameworks** are now embedded with health and wellness details to **maintain the quality of financial choices, reduce family conflicts and protect long-term wealth**. Annual family health reviews, financial-wellness dashboards, early detection and intervention directives can ensure that the family remains financially resilient and less prone to crisis-driven financial decisions. Formalising rules to prevent major financial decisions during illness, burnout or cognitive overload ensure decisions are of optimal quality across generations.



- Elaborate funding frameworks are included to **standardise protocol on handling longevity and well-being** across generations. Fund allocation towards assisted living, preventive care and digital therapeutics are outlined. Guardrails on liquidity are included to avoid any forced asset liquidation during extended care needs.



- **Wellness literacy** is incorporated into beneficiary education initiatives to ensure that the younger generation understands its health data rights and behavioural guardrails in financial decision-making and inculcates wellness stewardship.

Emerging trends in the holistic wealth space

Investors are considering health and wellness as a strategic financial asset capable of extending earning capacity, improving decision-making, protecting savings and reducing unplanned portfolio liquidation or withdrawals.

A stable health profile allows disciplined investing and uninterrupted compounding of wealth. It is important to stay up to date on the emerging trends in the holistic wealth space to stay agile and adaptive in your wealth journey. Some of the key trends that are redefining this space are:



Health insurance is shifting from a claims-only model to a proactive ecosystem that includes preventive care, mental health support, digital health analytics and wellness coaching. Integrated wellness insurance and preventive interventions are proving to be financially accretive.

Insurance and other techniques to handle health shocks have measurable mental and emotional health benefits. Improved mental and emotional health can lead to rational money decisions and is now seen as a wealth preservation factor.



Wearables and health analytics are integrated into financial planning and risk assessment to support personalised mental/emotional coaching and reduced medical cost. Real-time health data is becoming a tool for hyper-personalising wealth advice and risk management.

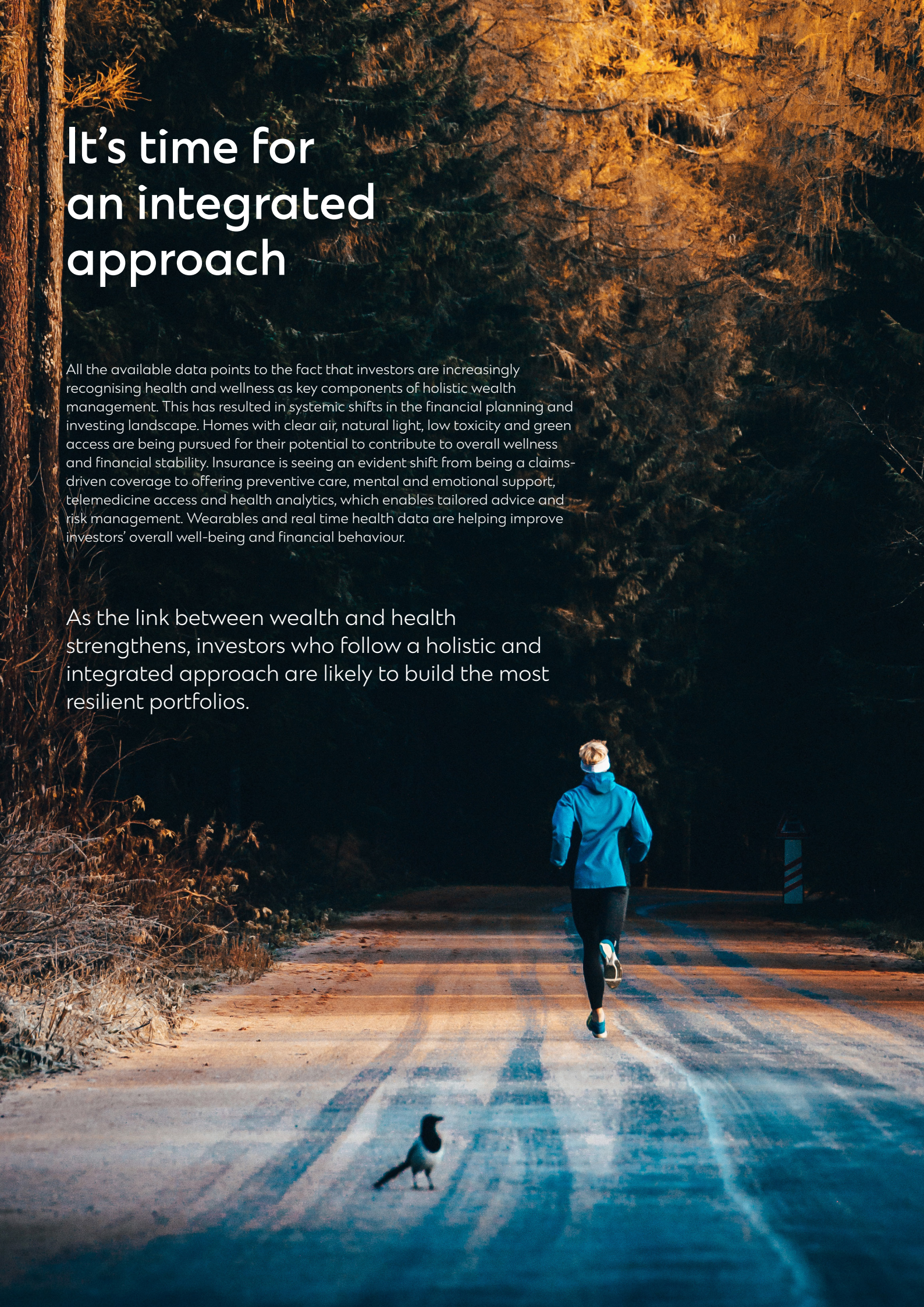
Wellness-centred real estate is becoming a mainstream investment option. It is seen as a long-term health stabiliser and value accelerator. Sustainable and biophilic designs have become financial variables, as health-engineered environments reduce health risk, enhance productivity and preserve wealth.



It's time for an integrated approach

All the available data points to the fact that investors are increasingly recognising health and wellness as key components of holistic wealth management. This has resulted in systemic shifts in the financial planning and investing landscape. Homes with clear air, natural light, low toxicity and green access are being pursued for their potential to contribute to overall wellness and financial stability. Insurance is seeing an evident shift from being a claims-driven coverage to offering preventive care, mental and emotional support, telemedicine access and health analytics, which enables tailored advice and risk management. Wearables and real time health data are helping improve investors' overall well-being and financial behaviour.

As the link between wealth and health strengthens, investors who follow a holistic and integrated approach are likely to build the most resilient portfolios.



Disclosure

This document is confidential and may also be privileged. If you are not the intended recipient, please destroy all copies and notify the sender immediately. This document is being distributed for general information only and is subject to the relevant disclaimers available at our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures. It is not and does not constitute research material, independent research, an offer, recommendation or solicitation to enter into any transaction or adopt any hedging, trading or investment strategy, in relation to any securities or other financial instruments. This document is for general evaluation only. It does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs of any particular person or class of persons and it has not been prepared for any particular person or class of persons. You should not rely on any contents of this document in making any investment decisions. Before making any investment, you should carefully read the relevant offering documents and seek independent legal, tax and regulatory advice. In particular, we recommend you to seek advice regarding the suitability of the investment product, taking into account your specific investment objectives, financial situation or particular needs, before you make a commitment to purchase the investment product. Opinions, projections and estimates are solely those of SC at the date of this document and subject to change without notice. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. The value of investments, and the income from them, can go down as well as up, and you may not recover the amount of your original investment. You are not certain to make a profit and may lose money. Any forecast contained herein as to likely future movements in rates or prices or likely future events or occurrences constitutes an opinion only and is not indicative of actual future movements in rates or prices or actual future events or occurrences (as the case may be). This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of the Standard Chartered Group (as defined below). Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered PLC, the ultimate parent company of Standard Chartered Bank, together with its subsidiaries and affiliates (including each branch or representative office), form the Standard Chartered Group. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of Standard Chartered. Private banking activities may be carried out internationally by different legal entities and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group (each an "SC Group Entity") according to local regulatory requirements. Not all products and services are provided by all branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group. Some of the SC Group Entities only act as representatives of Standard Chartered Private Bank and may not be able to offer products and services or offer advice to clients.

Copyright © 2026, Accounting Research & Analytics, LLC d/b/a CFRA (and its affiliates, as applicable). Reproduction of content provided by CFRA in any form is prohibited except with the prior written permission of CFRA. CFRA content is not investment advice and a reference to or observation concerning a security or investment provided in the CFRA SERVICES is not a recommendation to buy, sell or hold such investment or security or make any other investment decisions. The CFRA content contains opinions of CFRA based upon publicly-available information that CFRA believes to be reliable and the opinions are subject to change without notice. This analysis has not been submitted to, nor received approval from, the United States Securities and Exchange Commission or any other regulatory body. While CFRA exercised due care in compiling this analysis, CFRA, ITS THIRD-PARTY SUPPLIERS, AND ALL RELATED ENTITIES SPECIFICALLY DISCLAIM ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, ANY WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE OR USE, to the full extent permitted by law, regarding the accuracy, completeness, or usefulness of this information and assumes no liability with respect to the consequences of relying on this information for investment or other purposes. No content provided by CFRA (including ratings, credit-related analyses and data, valuations, model, software or other application or output therefrom) or any part thereof may be modified, reverse engineered, reproduced or distributed in any form by any means, or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of CFRA, and such content shall not be used for any unlawful or unauthorized purposes. CFRA and any third-party providers, as well as their directors, officers, shareholders, employees or agents do not guarantee the accuracy, completeness, timeliness or availability of such content. In no event shall CFRA, its affiliates, or their third-party suppliers be liable for any direct, indirect, special, or consequential damages, costs, expenses, legal fees, or losses (including lost income or lost profit and opportunity costs) in connection with a subscriber's, subscriber's customer's, or other's use of CFRA's content.

Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) Disclaimer

Banking activities may be carried out internationally by different branches, subsidiaries and affiliates within the Standard Chartered Group according to local regulatory requirements. Opinions may contain outright "buy", "sell", "hold" or other opinions. The time horizon of this opinion is dependent on prevailing market conditions and there is no planned frequency for updates to the opinion. This opinion is not independent of Standard Chartered Group's trading strategies or positions. Standard Chartered Group and/or its affiliates or its respective officers, directors, employee benefit programmes or employees, including persons involved in the preparation or issuance of this document may at any time, to the extent permitted by applicable law and/or regulation, be long or short any securities or financial instruments referred to in this document or have material interest in any such securities or related investments. Therefore, it is possible, and you should assume, that Standard Chartered Group has a material interest in one or more of the financial instruments mentioned

herein. Please refer to our Standard Chartered website under Regulatory disclosures for more detailed disclosures, including past opinions/ recommendations in the last 12 months and conflict of interests, as well as disclaimers. A covering strategist may have a financial interest in the debt or equity securities of this company/issuer. All covering strategist are licensed to provide investment recommendations under Monetary Authority of Singapore or Hong Kong Monetary Authority. This document must not be forwarded or otherwise made available to any other person without the express written consent of Standard Chartered Group.

Sustainable Investments

Any ESG data used or referred to has been provided by Morningstar, Sustainalytics, MSCI or Bloomberg. Refer to 1) Morningstar website under Sustainable Investing, 2) Sustainalytics website under ESG Risk Ratings, 3) MSCI website under ESG Business Involvement Screening Research and 4) Bloomberg green, social & sustainability bonds guide for more information. The ESG data is as at the date of publication based on data provided, is for informational purpose only and is not warranted to be complete, timely, accurate or suitable for a particular purpose, and it may be subject to change. Sustainable Investments (SI): This refers to funds that have been classified as 'ESG Intentional Investments – Overall' by Morningstar. SI funds have explicitly stated in their prospectus and regulatory filings that they either incorporate ESG factors into the investment process or have a thematic focus on the environment, gender diversity, low carbon, renewable energy, water or community development. For equity, it refers to shares/stocks issued by companies with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible. For bonds, it refers to debt instruments issued by issuers with Sustainalytics ESG Risk Rating of Low/Negligible, and/or those being certified green, social, sustainable bonds by Bloomberg. For structured products, it refers to products that are issued by any issuer who has a Sustainable Finance framework that aligns with Standard Chartered's Green and Sustainable Product Framework, with underlying assets that are part of the Sustainable Investment universe or separately approved by Standard Chartered's Sustainable Finance Governance Committee. Sustainalytics ESG risk ratings shown are factual and are not an indicator that the product is classified or marketed as "green", "sustainable" or similar under any particular classification system or framework.

Country/Market Specific Disclosures

Bahrain: This document is being distributed in Bahrain by Standard Chartered Bank, Bahrain Branch, having its address at P.O. 29, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain, is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed by the Central Bank of Bahrain as a conventional retail bank. **Botswana:** This document is being distributed in Botswana by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank Botswana Limited which is a financial institution licensed under the Section 6 of the Banking Act CAP 46:04 and is listed in the Botswana Stock Exchange. **Brunei Darussalam:** This document is being distributed in Brunei Darussalam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Brunei Branch) | Registration Number RFC/61 and Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd | Registration Number RC20001003. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. Standard Chartered Securities (B) Sdn Bhd is a limited liability company registered with the Registry of Companies with Registration Number RC20001003 and licensed by Brunei Darussalam Central Bank as a Capital Markets Service License Holder with License Number BDCB/R/CMU/S3-CL and it is authorised to conduct Islamic investment business through an Islamic window. **China Mainland:** This document is being distributed in China by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (China) Limited which is mainly regulated by National Financial Regulatory Administration (NFRA), State Administration of Foreign Exchange (SAFE), and People's Bank of China (PBOC). **Hong Kong:** In Hong Kong, this document, except for any portion advising on or facilitating any decision on futures contracts trading, is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("SCBHK"), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. SCBHK has its registered address at 32/F, Standard Chartered Bank Building, 4-4A Des Voeux Road Central, Hong Kong and is regulated by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority and registered with the Securities and Futures Commission ("SFC") to carry on Type 1 (dealing in securities), Type 4 (advising on securities), Type 6 (advising on corporate finance) and Type 9 (asset management) regulated activity under the Securities and Futures Ordinance (Cap. 571) ("SFO") (CE No. AJ1614). The contents of this document have not been reviewed by any regulatory authority in Hong Kong and you are advised to exercise caution in relation to any offer set out herein. If you are in doubt about any of the contents of this document, you should obtain independent professional advice. Any product named herein may not be offered or sold in Hong Kong by means of any document at any time other than to "professional investors" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance. In addition, this document may not be issued or possessed for the purposes of issue, whether in Hong Kong or elsewhere, and any interests may not be disposed of, to any person unless such person is outside Hong Kong or is a "professional investor" as defined in the SFO and any rules made under that ordinance, or as otherwise may be permitted by that ordinance. In Hong Kong, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBHK, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC. **Ghana:** Standard Chartered Bank Ghana Limited accepts no liability and will not be liable for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. Past performance is not indicative of future results and no representation or warranty is made regarding future performance. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to feedback.ghana@sc.com. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 0302610750 for any questions or service queries. You are advised not to send any confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail, as Standard Chartered makes no representations or warranties as

to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. Standard Chartered shall not be responsible for any loss or damage suffered by you arising from your decision to use e-mail to communicate with the Bank. **India:** This document is being distributed in India by Standard Chartered in its capacity as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of any other third party financial products. Standard Chartered does not offer any 'Investment Advice' as defined in the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013 or otherwise. Services/products related securities business offered by Standard Chartered are not intended for any person, who is a resident of any jurisdiction, the laws of which imposes prohibition on soliciting the securities business in that jurisdiction without going through the registration requirements and/or prohibit the use of any information contained in this document. **Indonesia:** This document is being distributed in Indonesia by Standard Chartered Bank, Indonesia branch, which is a financial institution licensed and supervised by Otoritas Jasa Keuangan (Financial Service Authority) and Bank Indonesia. **Jersey:** In Jersey, Standard Chartered Private Bank is the Registered Business Name of the Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is regulated by the Jersey Financial Services Commission. Copies of the latest audited accounts of Standard Chartered Bank are available from its principal place of business in Jersey: PO Box 80, 15 Castle Street, St Helier, Jersey JE4 8PT. Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter in 1853 Reference Number ZC 18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. The Jersey Branch of Standard Chartered Bank is also an authorised financial services provider under license number 44946 issued by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority of the Republic of South Africa. Jersey is not part of the United Kingdom and all business transacted with Standard Chartered Bank, Jersey Branch and other SC Group Entity outside of the United Kingdom, are not subject to some or any of the investor protection and compensation schemes available under United Kingdom law. **Kenya:** This document is being distributed in Kenya by and is attributable to Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited. Investment Products and Services are distributed by Standard Chartered Investment Services Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited that is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority in Kenya, as a Fund Manager. Standard Chartered Bank Kenya Limited is regulated by the Central Bank of Kenya. **Malaysia:** This document is being distributed in Malaysia by Standard Chartered Bank Malaysia Berhad ("SCBMB"). Recipients in Malaysia should contact SCBMB in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. This document has not been reviewed by the Securities Commission Malaysia. The product lodgement, registration, submission or approval by the Securities Commission of Malaysia does not amount to nor indicate recommendation or endorsement of the product, service or promotional activity. Investment products are not deposits and are not obligations of, not guaranteed by, and not protected by SCBMB or any of the affiliates or subsidiaries, or by Perbadanan Insurans Deposit Malaysia, any government or insurance agency. Investment products are subject to investment risks, including the possible loss of the principal amount invested. SCBMB expressly disclaim any liability and responsibility for any loss arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) arising from the financial losses of the Investment Products due to market condition. **Nigeria:** This document is being distributed in Nigeria by Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited (SCB Nigeria), a bank duly licensed and regulated by the Central Bank of Nigeria. SCB Nigeria accepts no liability for any loss or damage arising directly or indirectly (including special, incidental or consequential loss or damage) from your use of these documents. You should seek advice from a financial adviser on the suitability of an investment for you, taking into account these factors before making a commitment to invest in an investment. To unsubscribe from receiving further updates, please send an email to clientcare.ng@sc.com requesting to be removed from our mailing list. Please do not reply to this email. Call our Priority Banking on 02 012772514 for any questions or service queries. SCB Nigeria shall not be responsible for any loss or damage arising from your decision to send confidential and/or important information to Standard Chartered via e-mail. SCB Nigeria makes no representations or warranties as to the security or accuracy of any information transmitted via e-mail. **Pakistan:** This document is being distributed in Pakistan by, and attributable to Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited having its registered office at PO Box 5556, I.I Chundrigar Road Karachi, which is a banking company registered with State Bank of Pakistan under Banking Companies Ordinance 1962 and is also having licensed issued by Securities & Exchange Commission of Pakistan for Security Advisors. Standard Chartered Bank (Pakistan) Limited acts as a distributor of mutual funds and referrer of other third-party financial products. **Singapore:** This document is being distributed in Singapore by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited (Registration No. 201224747C/ GST Group Registration No. MR-8500053-0, "SCBSL"). Recipients in Singapore should contact SCBSL in relation to any matters arising from, or in connection with, this document. SCBSL is an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank and is licensed to conduct banking business in Singapore under the Singapore Banking Act, 1970. Standard Chartered Private Bank is the private banking division of SCBSL. IN RELATION TO ANY SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT REFERRED TO IN THIS DOCUMENT, THIS DOCUMENT, TOGETHER WITH THE ISSUER DOCUMENTATION, SHALL BE DEEMED AN INFORMATION MEMORANDUM (AS DEFINED IN SECTION 275 OF THE SECURITIES AND FUTURES ACT, 2001 ("SFA")). THIS DOCUMENT IS INTENDED FOR DISTRIBUTION TO ACCREDITED INVESTORS, AS DEFINED IN SECTION 4A(1)(a) OF THE SFA, OR ON THE BASIS THAT THE SECURITY OR SECURITIES-BASED DERIVATIVES CONTRACT MAY ONLY BE ACQUIRED AT A CONSIDERATION OF NOT LESS THAN S\$200,000 (OR ITS EQUIVALENT IN A FOREIGN CURRENCY) FOR EACH TRANSACTION. Further, in relation to any security or securities-based derivatives contract, neither this document nor the Issuer Documentation has been registered as a prospectus with the Monetary Authority of Singapore under the SFA. Accordingly, this document and any other document or material in connection with the offer or sale, or invitation for subscription or purchase, of the product may not be circulated or distributed,

nor may the product be offered or sold, or be made the subject of an invitation for subscription or purchase, whether directly or indirectly, to persons other than a relevant person pursuant to section 275(1) of the SFA, or any person pursuant to section 275(1A) of the SFA, and in accordance with the conditions specified in section 275 of the SFA, or pursuant to, and in accordance with the conditions of, any other applicable provision of the SFA. In relation to any collective investment schemes referred to in this document, this document is for general information purposes only and is not an offering document or prospectus (as defined in the SFA). This document is not, nor is it intended to be (i) an offer or solicitation of an offer to buy or sell any capital markets product; or (ii) an advertisement of an offer or intended offer of any capital markets product.

Deposit Insurance Scheme: Singapore dollar deposits of non-bank depositors are insured by the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation, for up to S\$100,000 in aggregate per depositor per Scheme member by law. Foreign currency deposits, dual currency investments, structured deposits and other investment products are not insured. This advertisement has not been reviewed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Taiwan: SC Group Entity or Standard Chartered Bank (Taiwan) Limited ("SCB (Taiwan)") may be involved in the financial instruments contained herein or other related financial instruments. The author of this document may have discussed the information contained herein with other employees or agents of SC or SCB (Taiwan). The author and the above-mentioned employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have taken related actions in respect of the information involved (including communication with customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) as to the information contained herein). The opinions contained in this document may change, or differ from the opinions of employees of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC and SCB (Taiwan) will not provide any notice of any changes to or differences between the above-mentioned opinions. This document may cover companies with which SC or SCB (Taiwan) seeks to do business at times and issuers of financial instruments. Therefore, investors should understand that the information contained herein may serve as specific purposes as a result of conflict of interests of SC or SCB (Taiwan). SC, SCB (Taiwan), the employees (including those who have discussions with the author) or customers of SC or SCB (Taiwan) may have an interest in the products, related financial instruments or related derivative financial products contained herein; invest in those products at various prices and on different market conditions; have different or conflicting interests in those products. The potential impacts include market makers' related activities, such as dealing, investment, acting as agents, or performing financial or consulting services in relation to any of the products referred to in this document.

UAE: DIFC – Standard Chartered Bank is incorporated in England with limited liability by Royal Charter 1853 Reference Number ZC18. The Principal Office of the Company is situated in England at 1 Basinghall Avenue, London, EC2V 5DD. Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. Standard Chartered Bank, Dubai International Financial Centre having its offices at Dubai International Financial Centre, Building 1, Gate Precinct, P.O. Box 999, Dubai, UAE is a branch of Standard Chartered Bank and is regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority ("DFSA"). This document is intended for use only by Professional Clients and is not directed at Retail Clients as defined by the DFSA Rulebook. In the DIFC we are authorised to provide financial services only to clients who qualify as Professional Clients and Market Counterparties and not to Retail Clients. As a Professional Client you will not be given the higher retail client protection and compensation rights and if you use your right to be classified as a Retail Client we will be unable to provide financial services and products to you as we do not hold the required license to undertake such activities. For Islamic transactions, we are acting under the supervision of our Shariah Supervisory Committee. Relevant information on our Shariah Supervisory Committee is currently available on the Standard Chartered Bank website in the Islamic banking section. For residents of the UAE – Standard Chartered UAE ("SC UAE") is licensed by the Central Bank of the U.A.E. SC UAE is licensed by Securities and Commodities Authority to practice Promotion Activity. SC UAE does not provide financial analysis or consultation services in or into the UAE within the meaning of UAE Securities and Commodities Authority Decision No. 48/r of 2008 concerning financial consultation and financial analysis.

Uganda: Our Investment products and services are distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Uganda Limited, which is licensed by the Capital Markets Authority as an investment adviser.

United Kingdom: In the UK, Standard Chartered Bank is authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority and Prudential Regulation Authority. This communication has been approved by Standard Chartered Bank for the purposes of Section 21 (2) (b) of the United Kingdom's Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 ("FSMA") as amended in 2010 and 2012 only. Standard Chartered Bank (trading as Standard Chartered Private Bank) is also an authorised financial services provider (license number 45747) in terms of the South African Financial Advisory and Intermediary Services Act, 2002. The Materials have not been prepared in accordance with UK legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research, and that it is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Vietnam: This document is being distributed in Vietnam by, and is attributable to, Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited which is mainly regulated by State Bank of Vietnam (SBV). Recipients in Vietnam should contact Standard Chartered Bank (Vietnam) Limited for any queries regarding any content of this document.

Zambia: This document is distributed by Standard Chartered Bank Zambia Plc, a company incorporated in Zambia and registered as a commercial bank and licensed by the Bank of Zambia under the Banking and Financial Services Act Chapter 387 of the Laws of Zambia.